# UPES Policy & Governance Manual

UPES
UNIVERSITY OF TOMORROW

A unified framework for University-level governance and policies.

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## Purpose of the Manual

The **UPES Policy & Governance Manual** establishes the institutional framework governing the formulation, approval, implementation, and oversight of all University-level policies at UPES.

The Manual:

- Ensures consistency and transparency in governance
- Clearly distinguishes policies from operational instruments
- Serves as the single authoritative reference for academic and administrative decision-making
- Aligns institutional practices with applicable regulatory and statutory requirements

This Manual shall be the **primary and controlling reference** for all University policies.

## Policy Hierarchy at UPES

UPES follows a defined policy hierarchy to maintain governance clarity. Instruments at lower levels exist only to operationalise approved policies and shall not override higher-level instruments.

**Order of Authority:**

1. **University Policies**: Approved institutional rules and governance provisions
2. **Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs)**: Documents operationalising policy provisions
3. **Guidelines / Frameworks**: Advisory or interpretative references
4. **Forms / Templates / Checklists**: Transactional execution tools
5. **Student FAQs: A separate documents** to help explain University policies in simple language.

In case of inconsistency, **University Policies shall prevail**.

## Authority & Interpretation

Policy formulation, approval, and oversight shall be exercised through the designated competent authority, including the exercise of discretionary powers where required.

Policies shall be interpreted in line with their stated purpose, scope, and applicable regulatory provisions. In the event of conflicting interpretations or conflicts between policies and subordinate instruments, the decision of the competent authority shall be final and binding.

**Policy Domains**

All University-level policies at UPES are classified under defined domains to ensure consistency and ease of reference. Each policy is assigned a single primary domain, without restricting cross-referencing where required.

**Policy Coding Structure**

| Recognised Domains | Prefix |
|---|---|
| **Academic Governance** | AG |
| **Student Discipline** | DS |
| **Student Engagement & Experience** | SEE |
| **Inclusion, Equity & Access** | IEA |
| **Career Services** | CS |
| **Curriculum & Teaching** | CNT |
| **Research & Development** | RND |

Policy codes remain unchanged across revisions to ensure continuity and auditability.

Note: This edition of the **UPES Policy & Governance Manual** currently includes policies under the **Academic Governance** domain.

Policies under other institutional domains are under review and development and shall be incorporated into this Manual in a phased manner, in accordance with the University's approved policy governance process.

**Master Policy Index**

The **Master Policy Index** serves as the primary navigation tool for this Manual and provides a consolidated overview of all approved University-level policies.

| Policy Code | Policy Title | Policy Domain | Applicable From | Status |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **AG-01** | Academic Progression Framework | Academic Governance | Overarching Framework | Active |
| **AG-02** | Assessment & Evaluation Policy | Academic Governance | Immediate | Active |
| **AG-03** | Attendance Policy | Academic Governance | Immediate | Active |
| **AG-04** | Academic Recovery Pathways (ARP) Policy | Academic Governance | Immediate | Active |
| **AG-05** | Academic Year Back & Progression Policy | Academic Governance | Admission Year 2025 | Active |
| **AG-06** | Supplementary Examination Policy | Academic Governance | Immediate | Active |
| **AG-07** | Directed Reading (DR) Policy | Academic Governance | Immediate | Active |
| **AG-08** | Summer Semester Policy | Academic Governance | Immediate | Active |
| **AG-09** | Regular Course Repeat Policy | Academic Governance | Immediate | Active |
| **AG-10** | Course Substitution Policy | Academic Governance | Academic Year, 2026 | Active |
| **AG-11** | Grade Improvement Policy | Academic Governance | Immediate | Active |
| **AG-12** | Audited Course Policy | Academic Governance | Immediate | Active |
| **AG-13** | Internal Academic Mobility Policy (Change of Programme / Major / Specialisation) | Academic Governance | Immediate | Active |
| **AG-14** | Change of Minor Policy | Academic Governance | Immediate | Active |

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **AG-15** | Lateral Entry & Inter-Institutional Migration Policy | Academic Governance | Immediate | Active |
| **AG-16** | Academic Appeals & Grievance Policy | Academic Governance | Immediate | Active |
| **AG-17** | Academic Integrity & Student Academic Misconduct Policy | Academic Governance | Immediate | Active |
| **DS- 01** | Student Discipline & Code of Conduct Policy | Proctorial Board | Immediate | Active |

# ACADEMIC PROGRESSION FRAMEWORK

**(Policy Code: AG-01)**

*This Policy shall come into force* ***with immediate effect****.*

## 1. Purpose

The UPES Academic Progression Framework establishes the **institutional architecture for academic progression** from admission to graduation across all Schools and Programmes.

**1.1** The Framework aims to:

**1.1.1** Provide a **unified, recovery-first progression logic** across the University

**1.1.2** Ensure **consistency, fairness, transparency, and predictability** in academic decisions

**1.1.3** Anchor all standalone academic policies within a **single institutional framework**

**1.2** This Framework shall be read **prior to and in conjunction with** all standalone academic policies governing assessment, attendance, progression, academic recovery, substitution, temporary exit, and graduation.

## 2. Guiding Principles of Academic Progression

Academic progression at UPES is governed by the following **non-negotiable principles**:

### 2.1 Progression with Accountability

Students may progress semester-wise, provided academic deficiencies are addressed within defined structures and timelines.

### 2.2 Recovery-First Philosophy

Clearing failed courses takes precedence over unrestricted forward progression.

### 2.3 Academic Rigour

Flexibility shall **not dilute academic standards, learning outcomes, or degree integrity**.

### 2.4 Student Choice with Responsibility

Academic choice is accompanied by clear responsibility for outcomes and implications.

### 2.5 Transparency & Predictability

Progression rules, thresholds, and consequences are clearly articulated and uniformly applied.

### 2.6 Completion Within Prescribed Duration

All progression and recovery pathways operate strictly within **UGC prescribed maximum Programme duration norms (N+2+1)**.

## 3. Concept of Academic Progression

**3.1** Academic progression at UPES is **credit-based, outcome-oriented, and continuous**, comprising:

**3.1.1** Course-level completion

**3.1.2** Semester-wise progression

**3.1.3** Credit accumulation

**3.1.4** Programme completion

**3.2** UPES follows a **Continuous Academic Progression System**, under which:

**3.2.1** Students normally progress semester-wise even with pending academic deficiencies.

**3.2.2** Academic deficiencies do **not automatically interrupt semester progression.**

**3.2.3** All deficiencies must be addressed through **Academic Recovery Pathways (ARP).**

**3.3** Progression is subject to:

**3.3.1** Eligibility and prerequisite requirements.

**3.3.2** Clearance of deficiencies within the prescribed maximum Programme duration.

**3.4** Progression does **not** require all courses to be cleared in the first attempt. However, **all required credits must be cleared prior to graduation**.

**3.5** Such progression is subject to academic eligibility conditions, including attendance requirements, prerequisite fulfilment, and policy-defined limits, as outlined in subsequent sections.

## 4. Structure of the Academic Year

**4.1** The academic year consists of:

**4.1.1** **Regular Semesters** (Odd and Even)

**4.1.2** **Optional Summer Semester**, where notified

**4.2** Each Programme prescribes a recommended credit load, with flexibility subject to:

**4.2.1** Maximum permissible credit limits*

**4.2.2** Academic feasibility

**4.2.3** Policy-defined approvals

** Maximum permissible credit limit is 27 credits per semester. For BCI/PCI-regulated programmes, where the prescribed semester load exceeds 24 credits, an additional credit overload of up to 15%of the semester's credit requirement may be permitted.*

**4.3** The **Summer Semester** functions as an academic **recovery, improvement and/or acceleration mechanism**, governed by standalone policies.

### 4.4 Minimum Annual Credit Requirement

Each degree Programme at UPES shall be structured to ensure a **minimum academic engagement of 40 credits per academic year**, aligned with the standard duration of the Programme.

**4.4.1** The **minimum total credit requirements** for undergraduate degree Programmes are as follows:

| Standard Duration of Programme | Minimum Total Credits |
|---|---|
| Three-Year Degree Programme | 120 credits |
| Four-Year Degree / Honours Programme | 160 credits |
| Five-Year Integrated Degree Programme | 200 credits |

**4.4.2** Accordingly, every **School / Cluster / Department / Centre** of the University shall ensure that the **annual credit offering for each Programme is not less than 40 credits**, unless otherwise permitted under an approved accelerated or flexible progression pathway.

**4.4.3** Where a Programme requires **additional credits beyond the minimum prescribed for its duration**, such requirements must be:

**4.4.3.1** Academically justified and documented

**4.4.3.2** Approved by the **Board of Studies (BoS)**

**4.4.3.3** Approved by the **Academic Council**

## 5. Teaching–Learning & Assessment Governance

**5.1** Academic progression is anchored in structured teaching–learning processes, including:

**5.1.1** Defined Course Outcomes (COs)

**5.1.2** Approved syllabi and course plans

**5.1.3** Transparent assessment schemes

**5.1.4** Faculty responsibility for delivery, mentoring, and academic guidance

**5.2** Assessment serves both:

**5.2.1** **Formative purposes** (learning and feedback), and

**Summative purposes** (certification)

**5.3** The assessment cycle comprises:

**5.3.1** Continuous / Internal Assessment

**5.3.2** Mid-Course Evaluation

**5.3.3** End-Term Examination

**5.4** Detailed procedures are governed by standalone policies and SOPs.

## 6. Semester-Wise Progression & Eligibility

**6.1** A student shall normally progress from one semester to the next **irrespective of SGPA or CGPA**, subject to:

1. Compliance with **attendance requirements**
2. Fulfilment of **course prerequisites**
3. Programme-specific eligibility norms

**6.2** Students who do not meet prerequisites for a course **shall not be permitted to register** for that course.

**6.3** For Programmes governed by external regulatory bodies (e.g., PCI, BCI), **council regulations shall prevail**.

## 7. Grading System

### 7.1 Letter Grades & Grade Points

| Grade | Description | Grade Point |
|---|---|---|
| O | Outstanding | 10.0 |
| A+ | Excellent | 9.0 |
| A | Very Good | 8.0 |
| B+ | Good | 7.0 |
| B | Above Average | 6.0 |
| C+ | Average | 5.0 |
| C | Pass | 4.0 |
| F | Fail | 0.0 |
| Ab | Fail (Absent) | 0.0 |
| R | Result Withheld | – |
| W | Withdrawn from the Course | – |
| Z | Course Continuation (year-long courses/projects) | – |
| AP | Audit Pass (voluntary, non-credit course) | – |
| AF | Audit Fail (voluntary, non-credit course) | – |
| S | Satisfactory (mandatory, non-credit course) | – |
| U | Unsatisfactory (mandatory, non-credit course) | – |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| TR | Transfer Credits (Exchange / Lateral Entry) | – |

### 7.2 Grading Methodology

| Batch Size | Grading Method |
|---|---|
| ≤ 21 students | Absolute Grading |
| > 21 students | Relative Grading |

*Grade boundaries under Relative Grading are confidential and determined by the course instructor. Under Absolute Grading, grade boundaries and rubrics must be announced in advance.*

### 7.3 Absolute Grading Scale – Undergraduate (UG)

*(Applicable when batch size ≤ 21)*

| Marks (%) | Grade | Grade Point |
|---|---|---|
| 85 – 100 | O | 10 |
| 75 – 84 | A+ | 9 |
| 65 – 74 | A | 8 |
| 55 – 64 | B+ | 7 |
| 45 – 54 | B | 6 |
| 40 – 44 | C+ | 5 |
| 35 – 39 | C | 4 |
| < 35 | F | 0 |

### 7.4 Absolute Grading Scale – Postgraduate (PG)

*(Applicable when batch size ≤ 21)*

| Marks (%) | Grade | Grade Point |
|---|---|---|
| 85 – 100 | O | 10 |
| 75 – 84 | A+ | 9 |
| 65 – 74 | A | 8 |
| 55 – 64 | B+ | 7 |
| 50 – 54 | B | 6 |
| 45 – 49 | C+ | 5 |
| 40 – 44 | C | 4 |
| < 40 | F | 0 |

## 7.5 Passing Criteria (Course Level)

| Programme | Minimum Composite Marks | Minimum Grade |
|---|---|---|
| Undergraduate (UG) | 35% | C |
| Postgraduate (PG) | 40% | C |

### 7.5.1 Additional Requirement:

**7.5.1.1** Presence in the **End-Term Examination / Jury** is mandatory.

**7.5.1.2** Failure to meet either condition results in an **F grade**.

## 7.6 SGPA & CGPA Requirements

| Programme Level | Minimum CGPA for Award of Degree | Minimum Grade per Course |
|---|---|---|
| Undergraduate (UG) | 5.00 | C |
| Postgraduate (PG) | 6.00 | C |

## 7. SGPA & CGPA Calculation Formulae

**Calculation of SGPA** **Calculation of CGPA**

| SGPA (Semester Grade Point Average) | | | | | | CGPA (Cumulative Grade Point Average) | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Subject | **Grade** | **Points** | **Credits** | **Total= (Points*Credits)** | | **Semester** | **SGPA** | **Credits** | **Total (SGPA*Credits)** |
| 1 | O | 10 | 3 | 30 | | Sem 1-SGPA | 7.2 | 27 | 194.4 |
| 2 | A+ | 9 | 4 | 36 | | Sem 2-SGPA | 8 | 26 | 208 |
| 3 | B+ | 7 | 4 | 28 | | Sem-3 SGPA | 9 | 29 | 261 |
| 4 | C | 4 | 2 | 8 | | Sem-4 SGPA | 7.5 | 27 | 202.5 |
| Total | | | **13** | **102** | | **Total** | | **109** | **865.9** |
| SGPA= Total (Points*Credit) / Total Credits = (102/13= 7.85) | | | | **7.85** | | **CGPA = Total (SGPA*Credits) Total** | | | 94. |

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | **Credits =(865.9/109=7.94)** | |

*For students who do not meet the individual course passing criteria, the Grade Card/Transcript shall reflect **"Fail".***

## 8. Credit Requirements for Award of Degree

**8.1** The award of any undergraduate or postgraduate degree shall be strictly contingent upon:

**8.1.1** Successful completion of **prescribed minimum credits**

**8.1.2** Compliance with approved academic structure

**8.1.3** Clearance of all academic deficiencies

**8.1.4** Reflection of credits in University records and the **Academic Bank of Credits (ABC)**, where applicable

**8.2** No degree shall be conferred unless all required credits are earned within the **stipulated maximum duration**.

## 9. Attendance, Prerequisites & Temporary Exit

**9.1** Attendance is an **academic eligibility requirement**, not a disciplinary measure

**9.2** Attendance-based failure results in academic ineligibility for the concerned course

**9.3** Prerequisites exist to ensure academic readiness and may restrict progression where unmet.

**9.4** The University permits **Temporary Exit / Break of Study** for personal, medical, or academic reasons.

**9.5** Temporary Exit:

**9.5.1** Is a pause, not recovery or reset

**9.5.2** Is distinct from Academic Year Back

**9.5.3** Is governed by a standalone policy

## 10. Enhanced & Accelerated Academic Progression (Fast-tracking a degree)

UPES recognises students capable of accelerated or enhanced progression. Such progression:

**10.1** Represents **positive advancement**, not recovery

**10.2** Is governed by academic feasibility, credit limits, and approvals

**10.3** Does not dilute academic standards

## 11. Institutional Philosophy on Academic Recovery

UPES adopts a **recovery-first academic philosophy**, under which:

**11.1** Students are provided **structured, time-bound recovery opportunities**

**11.2** Recovery mechanisms are **more rigorous than regular academic progression**

**11.3** Escalation occurs only when recovery proves ineffective

## 12. Academic Recovery Pathways (ARP)

Academic Recovery Pathways constitute the **primary mechanism** for addressing academic deficiencies and include:

**12.1** Supplementary Examination

**12.2** Summer Semester

**12.3** Directed Reading (DR)

**12.4** Regular Repeat

**12.5** Course Substitution (where permitted)

**12.6 Academic Year Back (Recovery & Progression Mode)**

ARP options are **not automatic entitlements** and are governed by eligibility and approval under standalone policies.

## 13. Academic Year Back (Recovery & Progression Mode)

Academic Year Back is a **mandatory recovery-and-progression control mechanism** applicable where academic difficulty becomes systemic. **Applicable from admission year 2025.**

**13.1 Trigger**

**13.1.1** Failure of **50% or more credits in an academic year** (Odd + Even semesters combined)

**13.2 Key Positioning**

**13.2.1** Mandatory and non-discretionary

**13.2.2** Does **not** constitute repetition of the entire academic year

**13.2.3** Does **not** annul earned credits

**13.2.4** Requires compulsory backlog clearance before further progression

**13.2.5** Permits limited, conditional forward movement

**13.2.6** Applicable from admission year 2025.

Detailed operational rules are governed by the **Academic Year Back & Progression Policy**.

## 14. Academic Records

UPES maintains academic records that are:

**14.1** Accurate

**14.2** Transparent

## 15. Equity, Due Process & Appeals

Academic progression rules are applied uniformly across Schools and Programmes through:

**15.1** Defined eligibility criteria

**15.2** Documented approval workflows

**15.3** Formal communication and record entry

Appeals and grievances are addressed through established institutional mechanisms.

## 16. Relationship with Standalone Academic Policies

This Framework serves as the **interpretive anchor** for all standalone academic policies.

## 17. Policy Navigation Guide

**17.1** Refer to this Framework for **progression logic and philosophy**

**17.2** Refer to relevant standalone policies for **eligibility and procedures**

**17.3** Consult SOPs and annexures for **operational execution**

# ASSESSMENT & EVALUATION POLICY

**(Policy Code: AG-02)**

*This Policy shall come into force* ***with immediate effect***

## 1. Purpose

This Policy establishes a comprehensive, transparent, and academically rigorous framework for **assessment and evaluation of student learning** at UPES.

The objectives of this Policy are to:

**1.1** Ensure fairness, consistency, and equity in assessment practices across all Schools and Programmes

**1.2** Promote continuous learning through formative assessment while retaining appropriate summative evaluation

**1.3** Uphold academic integrity and credibility of University awards

## 2. Scope & Applicability

This Policy applies to:

**2.1** All **Undergraduate (UG) and Postgraduate (PG)** Programmes offered by UPES

**2.2** All courses delivered in **regular academic semesters**

**2.3** All students, faculty members, and academic administrators involved in assessment and evaluation

This Policy shall be read in conjunction with:

**2.4** Examination and Allied Provisions, Regulations (as notified by the Office of the Controller of Examinations)

Wherever operational details are not specified herein, the **Examination and Allied Provisions, Regulations** shall prevail.

## 3. Assessment Philosophy

UPES follows an **instructor-led, outcome-oriented, and predominantly formative (continuous) evaluation system**.

The assessment framework is designed to:

**3.1** Evaluate learning progressively across a semester

**3.2** Reduce over-dependence on a single final examination

**3.3** Measure both conceptual understanding and applied competence

**3.4** Provide timely academic feedback to students

Assessment and evaluation shall be aligned with **Course Outcomes (COs)**, **Programme Outcomes (POs)**, and approved curriculum structures.

## 4. Definitions

| Term | Definition |
|---|---|
| **Assessment** | The process of measuring student learning through structured academic tasks and evaluations. |
| **Evaluation** | The academic judgment of student performance based on assessed outcomes. |
| **Continuous Assessment (CA)** | All in-semester assessment components conducted before the End-Term Examination. |
| **Mid-Course Evaluation (MCE)** | A formal assessment conducted around the midpoint of the semester, forming part of CA. |
| **End-Term Examination** | The final assessment conducted at the end of the semester to evaluate cumulative learning outcomes. |
| **Absolute Grading** | A grading system in which student performance is evaluated against **predefined and fixed performance thresholds**, independent of peer performance. Grade boundaries and evaluation criteria are **declared in advance** and applied uniformly to all students enrolled in the course. |
| **Relative Grading** | A grading system in which student performance is evaluated **in relation to the performance of the cohort**, and grades are assigned based on **comparative academic standing** rather than fixed score thresholds. Grade boundaries are determined through approved academic judgment and are not disclosed to students. |

## 5. Standard Assessment Structure

As a standard University practice, **theory courses in all Undergraduate (UG) and Postgraduate (PG) Programmes** shall follow the assessment structures outlined below, based on the **year of enrolment**

### 5.1 Enrolment Year 2023–24 Onwards

Theory courses shall be evaluated using the following assessment structure:

| Assessment Component | Weightage |
|---|---|
| **Continuous Assessment (CA)** | **70%** |
| **– Internal Assessments** | 50% |
| **– Mid-Course Evaluation (MCE)** | 20% |

| | |
|---|---|
| **End-Term Examination** | **30%** |
| **Total** | **100%** |

For clarity, the **Mid-Course Evaluation (MCE)** is an **integral component of Continuous Assessment (CA)** and shall **not be treated as a standalone assessment category**.

* The assessment structure may vary across Schools, programmes, or specific courses. Any deviation from the provisions outlined above should follow specifications in Clause 6 below.

### 5.2 Enrolment Years 2021–22 and 2022–23

Students enrolled in the academic years **2021–22 and 2022–23** shall continue to be governed by the assessment structure applicable at the time of their enrolment, as detailed below:

| Assessment Component | Weightage |
|---|---|
| **Internal Assessment** | 30% |
| **Mid-Semester Examination** | 20% |
| **End-Term Examination** | 50% |
| **Total** | **100%** |

This differential assessment structure ensures **academic continuity** for earlier cohorts while implementing the revised assessment framework for students enrolled from **Academic Year 2023–24 onwards**.

## 6. Approved Deviations from Standard Assessment Structure

### 6.1 Permissible Deviations

Recognising disciplinary diversity and pedagogical requirements, certain Schools/Programmes/Courses may adopt an **alternative assessment structure.**

Such deviation shall be permitted **only when**:

**6.1.1** The academic nature of the course justifies continuous evaluation *(e.g., studio-based, laboratory-intensive, design-oriented, practice-driven, project-centric, or skill-based courses)*

**6.1.2** The assessment design is:

**6.1.2.1** Academically defensible

**6.1.2.2** Outcome-aligned

**6.1.2.3** Clearly documented

**6.1.3 Prior approval of the Academic Council** is obtained

Post-facto approvals, instructor-level decisions, or ad-hoc deviations are **not permitted**.

### 6.2 Transparency to Students

For the approved deviations:

**6.2.1** The assessment structure shall be:

- **6.2.1.1** Explicitly stated in the course syllabus
- **6.2.1.2** Communicated to students at the start of the semester
- **6.2.1.3** Uniform across all sections of the course

A 100% CA structure shall **not be construed as reduced academic rigor**.

## 7. Continuous / Formative Assessment (CA)

### 7.1 Purpose

Continuous Assessment evaluates student performance **throughout the semester** and is intended to:

- **7.1.1** Encourage sustained academic engagement
- **7.1.2** Provide formative feedback
- **7.1.3** Assess diverse competencies beyond written examinations

### 7.2 Components of CA

Depending on course design, CA may include one or more of the following components:

- **7.2.1** Assignments
- **7.2.2** Quizzes and class tests (including surprise quizzes
- **7.2.3** Mid-Course Evaluations (MCE)
- **7.2.4** Projects and mini projects
- **7.2.5** Presentations and group discussions
- **7.2.6** Laboratory and practical assessments
- **7.2.7** Term papers
- **7.2.8** Open-book examinations
- **7.2.9** Class participation
- **7.2.10** Other academically approved tasks as defined in the course plan

### 7.3 Disclosure of CA Scheme

For each course, the instructor shall ensure that the following are communicated **on or before the first day of class** and published on the University's **Learning Management System (LMS)**:

- **7.3.1** CA components

**7.3.2** Number of assessments

**7.3.3** Individual weightages

**7.3.4** Mode of evaluation

No new CA component or weightage change shall be introduced mid-semester without formal academic approval of the respective Dean.

## 8. Mid-Course Evaluation (MCE)

**8.1** MCE is a **mandatory and formal 2 hour assessment** conducted around the midpoint of the semester

**8.2** It evaluates learning outcomes covered in the first half of the course

**8.3** MCE carries **20% weightage** as part of Continuous Assessment

**8.4** Marks obtained in MCE contribute directly to the final course grade

**8.5** Exceptions as per early release policy may be allowed.

**8.6** For non-theory courses, the assessment components and their respective weightages or evaluation modes may vary as prescribed by the concerned School, subject to prior approval by the Board of Study.

## 9. End-Term / Summative Examination (ETE)

**9.1** The End-Term Examination is the **final summative assessment** conducted at the end of the semester

**9.2** It evaluates cumulative course learning outcomes

**9.3** ETE carries **30% weightage**, unless an approved deviation exists

**9.4** Eligibility to appear for ETE is governed by:

**9.4.1** Attendance norms

**9.4.2** Submission of Teaching Quality Feedback

**9.4.3** No fees and disciplinary hold

**9.5 Appearance in the End-Term Examination is mandatory for successful completion of a course.**

**9.6** A student who does not appear for the End-Term Examination shall be **declared failed in the course**, irrespective of marks obtained in Continuous Assessment.

**9.7** For non-theory courses, the assessment components and their respective weightages or evaluation modes may vary as prescribed by the concerned School, subject to prior approval by the Board of Study.

## 10. Consistency Across Sections & Moderation

**10.1** For courses offered across multiple sections or batches:

**10.1.1** Assessment components and weightages shall be **uniform**

**10.1.2** Evaluation standards shall be consistently applied

**10.2** Final grades may be subject to **academic moderation** through approved University mechanisms to ensure parity and fairness

**10.3** Moderation processes are internal and confidential

## 11. Final Grade Calculation

The final grade awarded in a course shall reflect the student's performance in:

**11.1** **Continuous Assessment (IA + Mid-Course Evaluation) - 70%**, and

**11.2** **End-Term Examination - 30%**, as per the approved assessment structure.

**11.3** Course grades awarded under this Policy shall be used for the computation of **Semester Grade Point Average (SGPA)** and **Cumulative Grade Point Average (CGPA)**, in accordance with the **Academic Progression Framework.**

## 12. Grading System

Depending on batch size and academic context, the University adopts either an **Absolute Grading System** or a **Relative Grading System**, as defined below.

The applicable grading system for a course shall be **declared at the beginning of the semester** and shall remain unchanged for the duration of the course.

### 12.1 Applicability of Absolute and Relative Grading

#### 12.1.1 Absolute Grading System

The **Absolute Grading System** shall be followed when the **batch size is up to and including twenty-one (21) students**.

Under this system:

**12.1.1.1** Grades are awarded based on **predefined performance thresholds**

**12.1.1.2** Student performance is evaluated **independently of peer performance**

**12.1.1.3** Grade boundaries reflect **absolute achievement standards**

**12.1.1.4** Grade cut-offs and grading rubrics are disclosed to students in advance

#### 12.1.2 Relative Grading System

The **Relative Grading System** shall be followed when the **batch size exceeds twenty-one (21) students**.

Under this system:

**12.1.2.1** Grades are awarded based on **relative performance within the cohort**

**12.1.2.2** Grade boundaries are determined using approved academic judgment

**12.1.2.3 Grade** distribution reflects cohort performance while maintaining academic rigor

## 12.2 Grade Boundaries and Transparency

### 12.2.1 Relative Grading

In the case of **Relative Grading**:

**12.2.1.1** Grade boundaries are determined based on cohort performance

**12.2.1.2** Grade cut-offs remain **confidential**

**12.2.1.3 Determination** of grade boundaries is a **prerogative of the course instructor**, subject to academic oversight

Students shall be informed of:

**12.2.1.4** The grading approach being followed (relative), and

**12.2.1.5** The assessment components and their respective weightages

However, **specific grade cut-offs shall not be disclosed** under the relative grading scheme.

### 12.2.2 Absolute Grading

In the case of **Absolute Grading**:

**12.2.2.1** The course instructor shall:

**12.2.2.1.1** Declare the **assessment criteria and grading rubric**

**12.2.2.1.2** Announce the **grade boundaries** at the beginning of the semester

**12.2.2.1.3** Publish the same as part of the **course outline / syllabus**

The University provides a **structure for absolute grade boundaries** for guidance *(Academic Progression Framework, Section 7).*

## 12.3 Consistency and Governance

**12.3.1** The grading system (absolute or relative), once declared for a course:

**12.3.1.1** Shall not be altered mid-semester

**12.3.1.2** Shall apply uniformly to all students registered in the course

**12.3.2** Any exception or deviation from the above provisions shall require **prior approval through the University's Academic Council / Board of Study**.

## 13. Passing Requirements

To successfully complete a course, a student must:

**13.1** Meet the **minimum course passing criteria**, and

**13.2** Fulfil any **component-wise minimum requirements**, where prescribed

Semester-level progression is governed by separate Academic Progression policies.

| Category | Programme Level | Rule / Requirement |
|---|---|---|
| **Failure Threshold** | Undergraduate (UG) | A total score of **less than 35 marks** in a course shall result in an **F (Fail) grade** |
| **Failure Threshold** | Postgraduate (PG) | A total score of **less than 40 marks** in a course shall result in an **F (Fail) grade** |
| **Minimum Passing Grade** | UG & PG | **Grade C** is the **minimum passing grade**. Students awarded **Grade C or above** are deemed to have successfully completed the course |
| **Highest Grade** | UG & PG | Students scoring **85 marks or above** shall be awarded the **highest grade (Grade O)** |

**13.3** Accumulation of course failures, SGPA/CGPA outcomes, and credit completion under this Policy may result in **Academic Year Back (AYB)** or other academic recovery statuses, strictly as governed by the **Academic Year Back & Progression Policy** of the University.

## 14. Student Rights: Viewing, Re-evaluation & Grievance

### 14.1 Viewing of Answer Scripts

**14.1.1** Students may view evaluated **End-Term answer scripts**, where applicable, on dates notified in the academic calendar

**14.1.2** Requests outside the notified window shall not be entertained

### 14.2 Re-evaluation

**14.2.1** Re-evaluation is permitted **only for End-Term Examination components**

**14.2.2** Continuous Assessment components are **not eligible** for re-evaluation

**14.2.3** Procedures and timelines are notified by the **Office of the Controller of Examinations (CoE)**

### 14.3 Grievance Redressal

Assessment-related grievances shall be addressed through prescribed academic grievance redressal mechanisms as notified by the University. *(Academic Grievance Redressal Policy)*

## 15. Supplementary Assessment

**15.1** Where applicable, Supplementary Examinations shall carry **weightage equivalent to the End-Term Examination**

**15.2** Continuous Assessment marks shall remain unchanged

**15.3** There shall be **no grade capping** for Supplementary Examinations

**15.4** Detailed rules governing Supplementary, Summer, and Directed Reading assessments are covered under separate policies and regulations

## 16. Academic Integrity

All assessment and evaluation activities are subject to University regulations on **academic integrity and examination conduct**.

Any form of malpractice, misconduct, or unfair means shall attract penalties as per applicable regulations, independent of this Policy.

## 17. Review & Amendments

This Policy shall be reviewed periodically to ensure continued relevance, regulatory compliance, and academic rigor.

Any amendment shall require approval through the University's Academic Council.

# ATTENDANCE POLICY

**(Policy Code: AG-03)**

*This Policy shall come into force* ***with immediate effect****.*

## 1. Purpose

**1.1** The Attendance Policy establishes a clear, uniform, and non-negotiable framework governing student attendance at UPES.

**1.2** It reinforces the University's commitment to academic discipline, classroom engagement, and learning continuity, while allowing flexibility for unforeseen circumstances.

## 2. Governing Principles

### 2.1 Attendance Expected: 100%

Students are expected to attend all scheduled academic activities for every registered course, including lectures, tutorials, laboratories, studios, fieldwork, and other instructional sessions.

### 2.2 Built-in Flexibility: 25%

A maximum attendance shortfall of up to 25% is inherently permitted to accommodate unforeseen, routine, or incidental circumstances during a semester.

### 2.3 Strict Eligibility Threshold: 75%

Maintenance of minimum 75% attendance per course is a mandatory eligibility condition to appear for the End-Term (Summative) Examination.

These principles are derived from the UPES Academic Handbook and applicable regulatory norms.

## 3. Scope of Application

This policy applies to:

**3.1** All undergraduate and postgraduate students

**3.2** All credit-bearing or non-credit bearing courses, including:

**3.3** Theory

**3.4** Laboratories / Studios

**3.5** Project-linked courses

Fieldwork and experiential components

**3.7** Audit Courses

**3.8** All modes of delivery:

**3.9** Regular Semester

**3.10** Summer Semester

**3.11** Directed Reading

**3.12** Regular Course Repeat

## 4. Attendance Recording

**4.1** Attendance shall be recorded through University-approved systems (ERP / biometric / LMS-integrated mechanisms, as applicable).

**4.2** Attendance records maintained in the official system shall be treated as final and binding.

## 5. Permissible Attendance Shortfall (Up to 25%)

A shortfall of up to 25% is automatically permitted to account for:

**5.1** Illness

**5.2** Personal exigencies

**5.3** Logistical or situational disruptions

**5.4** Other unforeseen circumstances

**5.5** This buffer:

**5.6** Does **not** require approval

**5.7** Does **not** require documentation

## 6. Minimum Attendance Requirement (Strict)

**6.1** Students must maintain **at least 75% attendance in each registered course**

**6.2** Attendance is calculated **course-wise**, not Programme-wise or semester-wise

**6.3** **No rounding up, approximation, or discretionary adjustment** shall be permitted

Failure to meet this requirement results in academic debarment for the concerned course.

## 7. Debarment Due to Attendance Shortage

### 7.1 Conditions for Debarment

A student shall be debarred from appearing in the End-Term Examination of a course if attendance is below 75%, **irrespective of performance in Continuous Assessment (CA) or Mid-Course Evaluation (MCE)**.

High CA/MCE scores, assignments, projects, or mid-semester performance shall **not** offset attendance shortage.

### 7.2 Academic Consequences

**7.2.1** The student shall be awarded an **'Ab' grade** in the concerned course due to attendance shortage

Such students:

**7.2.2** Are **not eligible** for Supplementary Examination

**7.2.3** Must **repeat the entire course** when next offered (Regular Repeat or Summer Semester or Directed Reading)

## 8. Student Responsibility

Students are solely responsible for:

**8.1** Monitoring their attendance

**8.2** Ensuring compliance with eligibility requirements

**Under no circumstances shall attendance relaxation be granted.**

## 9. Authority, Interpretation & University Discretion

The University, through its Academic Council or other competent authority, reserves the right to:

**9.1** Interpret and clarify this policy

**9.2** Modify attendance rules, thresholds, calculation mechanisms, or enforcement processes

**9.3** Amend or update provisions to ensure alignment with regulatory requirements, academic standards, and institutional priorities

Any such changes shall be notified through official University communication channels and shall be binding from the date specified.

# ACADEMIC RECOVERY PATHWAYS (ARP) POLICY

**(Policy Code: AG-04)**

*This Policy shall come into force* ***with immediate effect****.*

## 1. Purpose

**1.1** The Academic Recovery Pathways (ARP) Policy establishes a **structured, uniform, and rigorously governed framework** enabling students to recover from academic setbacks **without dilution of academic standards**, while ensuring:

**1.1.1** Compliance with UGC regulations

**1.1.2** Alignment with NEP 2020 and NCrF principles

**1.1.3** Timely academic progression within prescribed maximum Programme duration norms

**1.2** This Policy defines **limited, clearly governed recovery mechanisms** for addressing academic failure, attendance-related ineligibility, prerequisite blocks, and accumulated backlogs affecting academic progression.

## 2. Academic Progression & Recovery Philosophy

**2.1** UPES follows a **Recovery-First Academic Progression Model**, wherein:

**2.1.1** Clearing failed courses takes precedence over accumulation of new academic load

**2.1.2** Progression is governed by **defined attempt limits**, not discretionary approvals

**2.1.3** Academic flexibility is permitted **only within approved and capped recovery pathways**

**2.1.4** Progression aligns with UGC-prescribed **maximum Programme duration norms (N + 2 + 1)**

### 2.2 Principle of Academic Rigour in Recovery

All Academic Recovery Pathways shall be **academically more rigorous than regular course attempts**.

Recovery pathways:

**2.2.1** Require higher academic discipline, preparedness, and engagement

**2.2.2** Are subject to stricter eligibility conditions and scrutiny

**2.2.3** Shall not be construed as lenient, easier, or alternative pathways to bypass regular academic requirements

### 2.3 Principle of Enhanced Academic Accountability

Academic Recovery Pathways exist to **restore academic standing**, not to compensate for inadequate academic discipline.

Accordingly:

**2.3.1** Eligibility for recovery is conditional and not automatic

**2.3.2** Assessment standards shall be higher than regular attempts

**2.3.3** Monitoring, enforcement, and compliance expectations shall be stricter

**2.3.4** Recovery pathways shall not be used to offset repeated underperformance or attendance non-compliance

## 3. Scope

**3.1** This Policy applies to:

**3.1.1** All full-time Undergraduate and Postgraduate students of UPES

**3.1.2** All Schools, Departments, and Academic Units

**3.1.3** All credit-bearing courses, unless explicitly excluded

**3.2** This Policy governs recovery from:

**3.2.1** Academic failure (F grade)

**3.2.2** Attendance-based failure (Debarment)

**3.2.3** Prerequisite-based progression blocks

**3.2.4** Accumulated backlogs affecting progression

**3.3** For Programmes governed by statutory or professional regulatory bodies (including but not limited to the Bar Council of India (BCI) and the Pharmacy Council of India (PCI)), the applicable regulations of such bodies shall prevail in the event of any inconsistency with this Policy. Academic recovery options, eligibility, and attempt limits for such Programmes shall be implemented strictly in accordance with the relevant regulatory requirements.

## 4. Definitions

| Term | Definition |
|---|---|
| **N + 2 + 1 (Maximum Programme Duration)** | The maximum time permitted for completion of a Programme, calculated as the minimum prescribed duration of the Programme (N) plus two (2) additional academic years, and one (1) additional academic year with VC's approval. |
| **Continuous Assessment (CA)** | All internal evaluation components excluding End-Term Examination |
| **Mid-Course Evaluation (MCE)** | Mid-semester assessment conducted as part of CA |
| **Backlog** | A course with grade F, Ab, or I (I subsequently converted to F) |
| **Debarred** | Student ineligible for End-Term Examination due to attendance below 75% |
| **Regular Attempt** | First formal registration and assessment attempt of a course |

| | |
|---|---|
| **Recovery Attempt** | An approved attempt through ARP mechanisms |
| **Academic Recovery Pathways (ARP)** | Approved mechanisms for clearing failed courses |
| **Prerequisite Block** | Inability to register for a higher-level course due to uncleared prerequisite |
| **Major Core Course** | Compulsory degree requirement; not eligible for substitution |
| **Elective / Exploratory / Life Skills Course** | Non-core courses eligible for substitution |
| **ERP / Academic Portal** | University system for registration, grading, tracking, and audit |

## 5. Approved Academic Recovery Pathways

**5.1** UPES formally recognises the following **six (6)** Academic Recovery Pathways:

**5.1.1** Supplementary Examination *(Supplementary Examination Policy)*

**5.1.2** Summer Semester *(Summer Semester Policy)*

**5.1.3** Directed Reading (DR) *(Directed Reading (DR) Policy)*

**5.1.4** Regular Repeat (Full Repeat) *(Regular Course Repeat Policy)*

**5.1.5** Substitution of Eligible Elective Courses *(Course Substitution Policy)*

**5.1.6** Academic Year Back (Recovery & Progression Mode) *(Academic Year Back & Progression Policy)*

**5.2** No recovery mechanism beyond those listed above shall be permitted.

**5.3** All recovery attempts undertaken by a student shall be **recorded and reflected** in the official grade card and ERP.

## 6. Course Attempt Structure & Limits

### 6.1 Attempt Structure

Each course shall have:

**6.1.1** **One (1) Regular Attempt**, and

**6.1.2** **A maximum of two (2) Recovery Attempts** through approved Academic Recovery Pathways.

**6.2** Recovery attempts may be undertaken through:

**6.2.1** Supplementary Examination

**6.2.2** Summer Semester

**6.2.3** Directed Reading (DR)

#### 6.2.4 Regular Repeat

(in any combination, subject to eligibility conditions)

**6.3** All recovery attempts shall be counted within the two-attempt recovery limit. Beyond two (2) attempts a student is required to mandatorily re-register for the failed course in regular mode.

**6.4 Mandatory Regular Repeat**

Where a student has failed a course and e**xhausted the maximum number of permitted recovery attempts under the Academic Recovery Pathways, Regular Course Repeat shall be the only permissible mechanism** to continue attempts to clear the course and shall be mandatory in nature.

**The student will re-register for the course and repeat it in regular mode** with the subsequent batch. Such re-registration shall require full **compliance with attendance, assessment**, and academic requirements applicable to the regular offering of the course.

## 7. Eligibility Matrix

### 7.1 Course-Level Academic Conditions & Recovery Options

| Academic Condition | Supplementary | Summer | DR | Regular Repeat | Substitution |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Failed course (attendance ≥75%)** | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ (Electives only) |
| **Debarred due to attendance (<75%)** | ✗ | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ✗ |
| **Course not offered / timetable clash** | ✗ | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |
| **Failure of prerequisite course (attendance ≥75%)** | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ✗ |

### 7.2 Academic Year Back Status

| Academic Status | Trigger | Progression Impact | Access to Recovery |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Academic Year Back** | Failure of 50% or more credits in an academic year | **Mandatory first registration** in all failed / uncleared courses; remaining credit capacity may be used for next academic year courses, | ✓ Eligible to utilise applicable recovery options (Supplementary / Summer / Directed Reading / Regular |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | subject to prerequisites and maximum credit limits* | Course Repeat), subject to University rules |

** Maximum 27 credits per semester. For BCI/PCI-regulated programmes, where the prescribed semester load exceeds 24 credits, an additional credit overload of up to 15% of the semester's credit requirement may be permitted.*

### 7.3 Interpretive Notes

**7.3.1** **Academic Year Back is the only academic status** arising from academic failure and is triggered solely by failure of **50% or more credits in an academic year**.

**7.3.2** **Mandatory backlog-first registration** shall apply in all cases and shall take precedence over registration in higher-year courses.

**7.3.3** Failure of a prerequisite course **blocks registration of subsequent courses** until the prerequisite is cleared but **does not restrict the recovery pathway** used to clear the prerequisite.

**7.3.4** **Substitution is permitted only for Elective / Exploratory courses** and shall not apply to Major Core or prerequisite courses.

**7.3.5** All recovery options are subject to eligibility conditions, course availability, seat capacity, and approval by the competent academic authority.

## 8. Academic Recovery Pathways: Detailed Provisions

### 8.1 Supplementary Examination

**Purpose**

First recovery opportunity for students who met attendance requirements but failed academically in a course.

**Eligibility**

**8.1.1** F grade due to academic failure

**8.1.2** Minimum 75% attendance

**8.1.3** Continuous Assessment (CA) > 0, sufficient to be awarded a pass category after appearing in end term examinations

**8.1.4** Recovery attempts limit not exhausted

**Rules**

**8.1.5** Assessment: End-Term component only (30%)

**8.1.6** CA and MCE marks are carried forward

**8.1.7** Academic standard no lower than regular End-Term

**8.1.8** Conducted only in approved cycles

**8.1.9** Fee: As notified by the University

**8.1.10** Failure moves the student to the next eligible recovery pathway

## 8.2 Summer Semester / Summer School

**Purpose**

An intensive academic term for structured backlog clearance, prerequisite fulfilment, or permitted grade improvement.

**Eligibility**

**8.2.1** Students debarred from the End-Term Examination due to attendance shortage (<75%) and awarded an **Ab** grade

**8.2.2** Failed Supplementary Examination

**8.2.3** Also applicable to students seeking to:

**8.2.3.1** Improve grades or boost their CGPA

**8.2.3.2** Fulfil prerequisites for advanced courses

**8.2.3.3** Accelerate their graduation

**8.2.3.4** Pursue double majors or minors

**8.2.3.5** Earn additional specializations

**Rules**

**8.2.4** Maximum courses per student: two (2) per academic year

**8.2.5** Mandatory attendance: 75%

**8.2.6** Full assessment: CA + End-Term

**8.2.7** Academically intensive and not a lenient alternative

**8.2.8** Subject to faculty availability and institutional capacity

**8.2.9** Summer credits do not count toward regular semester credit ceiling, i.e. 27 credits per semester

## 8.3 Directed Reading (DR)

**Purpose**

Faculty-supervised independent learning recovery pathway.

**Eligibility**

**8.3.1** Failed Supplementary Examination

**8.3.2** Students debarred from the End-Term Examination due to attendance shortage (<75%) and awarded an F grade

**Rules**

**8.3.3** Registration for Directed Reading (DR) courses shall be permitted only up to a maximum of **15% of the total semester credit requirement of the Programme. Where** the 15% calculation results in a fractional credit value, the maximum permissible DR credits shall be determined by **standard mathematical rounding to the nearest whole credit**, with values of **0.50 and above rounded upward** and values **below 0.50 rounded downward**.

**8.3.4** Not permitted for labs, studios, internships, dissertations, capstones, or practice-based courses

**8.3.5** Assessment: CA + End-Term

**8.3.6** Minimum 75% engagement in scheduled sessions

**8.3.7** 1 contact hour compulsory with the concerned faculty every week

**8.3.8** Subject to School approval and faculty availability

**8.4 Regular Repeat (Full Repeat)**

**Purpose**
Allows full re-registration and completion of a course to clear failure or improve grade where permitted.

**Rules**

**8.4.1** Fresh completion of attendance, CA and End-Term

**8.4.2** No carry-forward of earlier CA or Mid-Course Evaluation (MCE)

**8.4.3** No additional fee beyond normal semester tuition.

**[Note:** Where a student is required to **repeat a course in regular mode after completion of the minimum prescribed Programme duration (N)**, such registration shall be treated as **extension of Programme duration**.

In such cases, the student shall be liable to pay **applicable fees for the extended duration**, as **notified by the University from time to time**, in accordance with approved fee regulations.]

**8.4.4** No academic relaxation or preferential treatment

**8.4.6 Managing timetable clashes and scheduling conflicts are the student's responsibility**

**8.4.6** Subject to seat availability

**8.5 Substitution of Elective Courses**

**Purpose**
Provides flexibility for non-core academic components.

**Eligibility**

**8.5.1** Elective / Exploratory courses only

**8.5.2** Not permitted for Major Core or their prerequisite courses

**8.5.3** Subject to seat availability

**Rules**

**8.5.4** Elective substitutions are permitted without a fixed cap, provided the approved Programme credit structure and category-wise credit requirements are maintained.

**8.5.5** Substituted grade replaces earlier grade

**8.5.6** Counts within credit load and attempt limits

**8.5.7** No further grade improvement permitted after substitution

**8.6 Academic Year Back (Recovery & Progression Mode)**

**Purpose**

Mandatory recovery mechanism for significant academic failure within an academic year. Applicable from admission year 2025.

**Trigger**

**8.6.1 Failure of 50% or more registered credits** across an academic year

**Key Principles**

**8.6.2** Earned credits remain valid

**8.6.3** Backlog clearance takes precedence

**8.6.4** Limited forward progression subject to AYB rules

**8.6.5** Mandatory academic advising applies

**8.7** Operational details are governed by the **Academic Year Back & Progression Policy**.

## 9. Academic Recovery Flow

**9.1 Attempt 1**: Regular Attempt

**9.2 Attempt 2**: Recovery Attempt (Supplementary / Summer / DR / Regular Repeat)

**9.3 Attempt 3**: Recovery Attempt (Supplementary / Summer / DR / Regular Repeat)

**9.4 Failure after recovery attempts**: Mandatory Regular Repeat in Regular Mode

## 10. Credit Load & Prerequisite Rules

10.1 Maximum credits per semester: 27 (For **BCI/PCI-regulated programmes**, where the prescribed semester load exceeds 24 credits, an additional **credit overload of up to 15%**of the semester's credit requirement may be permitted.)

**10.2** Prerequisites must be cleared before higher-level registration

**10.3** No prerequisite override shall be permitted beyond approved policies

## 11. Fees, Registration & Administration

| Pathway | Fee | Authority |
|---|---|---|
| **Supplementary** | As notified | ERP |
| **Summer Semester** | ₹3,000 / credit | Academic Planning & Operations (APO) |
| **Directed Reading** | ₹3,000 / credit | Dean + APO |
| **Regular Repeat** | No extra fees-Included in regular semester fees* | ERP |
| **Substitution** | No extra fees-Included in regular semester fees | Dean |

The University reserves the right to revise fees from time to time.

* Regular course repeat beyond the prescribed Programme duration (N) shall be subject to extended-duration fees, as notified by the University.

## 12. Governance & Responsibilities

| Stakeholder | Responsibility |
|---|---|
| **Academic Council** | Policy oversight |
| **Deans** | Academic approvals |
| **APO** | ERP tracking and communication |
| **CoE** | Assessment and grading |
| **Student** | Compliance and monitoring |

## 13. Audit, Compliance & Review

**13.1** All ARP actions shall be ERP-tracked

**13.2** Records retained for a minimum of five (5) years

**13.3** Annual review by Academic Council

## 14. Student Responsibilities

Students shall:

**14.1** Monitor backlogs, attempts, and Programme duration

**14.2** Register within prescribed timelines

**14.3** Seek academic advising proactively

## 15. Policy Authority

The University reserves the right to amend, interpret, or modify this Policy in accordance with regulatory requirements and institutional decisions. All interpretations issued by the University shall be final and binding.

# ACADEMIC YEAR BACK & PROGRESSION POLICY

**(Policy Code:AG-05)**

*Applicable from* ***Admission Year 2025***

## 1. Purpose

**1.1** This Policy establishes a structured **Academic Year Back (AYB)** framework at UPES for students who experience **significant academic failure within an academic year**.

**1.2** The Policy operationalises the University's Recovery-First Progression Model, ensuring that students:

**1.2.1** Compulsorily prioritise academic recovery before unrestricted progression

**1.2.2** Progress in a **controlled, prerequisite-protected, and academically viable manner**

**1.2.3** Remain within **UGC-prescribed maximum Programme duration norms (N + 2 + 1)**

**1.3** The Policy aims to:

**1.3.1** Prevent uncontrolled accumulation of academic backlogs

**1.3.2** Preserve curriculum sequencing and prerequisite integrity

**1.3.3** Provide a transparent, fair, and auditable recovery-cum-progression pathway

**1.3.4** Protect students from long-term academic, financial, and regulatory risk

**1.4** Programmes governed by **statutory or professional councils** (such as PCI-regulated or Law Programmes) may be subject to additional or modified progression rules, which shall prevail to the extent of any inconsistency with this Policy.

## 2. Scope

This Policy applies to:

**2.1** All full-time **Undergraduate and Postgraduate students of UPES**

**2.2** All **Schools, Programmes, and Academic Units**

**2.3** All **credit-bearing courses** contributing to Programme completion

## 3. Trigger for Academic Year Back

A student shall be placed on **Academic Year Back** if:

**3.1** The student fails **fifty per cent (50%) or more of the total registered credits in an academic year**, calculated cumulatively across **Odd and Even semesters**.

**3.1.1** Mandatory Nature

**3.1.1.1** Placement on **Academic Year Back is mandatory, automatic, and non-discretionary** upon meeting the trigger condition.

**3.1.1.2 Voluntary or elective placement on Academic Year Back is not permitted.**

## 4. Nature of Academic Year Back

**4.1** An Academic Year Back:

**4.1.1** **Does not** constitute repetition of the entire academic year

**4.1.2** **Does not** annul or invalidate earned credits

**4.1.3** Operates as a **structured recovery-and-progression year**, not a punitive measure

**4.2** The Academic Year Back framework is **corrective in intent**, designed to prioritise recovery while safeguarding long-term academic progression and regulatory compliance.

## 5. Academic Registration Framework During Academic Year Back

### 5.1 Mandatory Backlog Clearance

During Academic Year Back, the student must compulsorily register for all failed courses, as applicable:

**5.1.1** Failed **Odd Semester** courses → registered in the next Odd Semester

**5.1.2** Failed **Even Semester** courses → registered in the next Even Semester

5.1.2 Where a backlog course is offered through **Supplementary Examination or Directed Reading (DR)**, registration may occur in the semester/term in which such mode is officially notified and permitted.

The Odd–Odd and Even–Even registration principle shall primarily apply when the course is being repeated in Regular Mode.

Key principles:

**5.1.3 Backlog clearance shall take absolute precedence over all other registrations**

**5.1.4 No student on Academic Year Back may defer backlog registration in favour of** new courses

**5.1.5** All registrations remain subject to course-level attempt limits

**5.1.6** Academic Recovery Pathways (ARP) remains available for students to clear backlogs

**5.1.7 Directed Reading (DR):**

Directed Reading (DR) shall be permitted up to a **maximum of 15% of the total registered credits of the semester**.
Any fractional value resulting from the 15% calculation shall be rounded to the nearest whole credit, with values of 0.5 and above rounded up, and values below 0.5 rounded down.

### 5.2 Limited Forward Progression

*(Up to 50% of Normal Annual Credit Load)*

In addition to mandatory backlog courses, a student on Academic Year Back may be permitted to register for **new courses up to a maximum of the remaining percentage of the normal annual credit load,** subject to:

**5.2.1** No timetable clashes

**5.2.2** All **prerequisites being fully cleared**

**5.2.3** Adherence to semester-wise credit limits

**5.2.4** Explicit approval through the **Individual Study Plan (ISP)**

There shall be no entitlement to register for new courses beyond this limit.

### 5.3 Clarificatory Credit Examples (Academic Year Back)

| Example | Normal Annual Credit Load | Credits Failed | % Failed | Mandatory Backlog Registration | Maximum New Credits Allowed (Next Academic Year) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Example 1** | 40 credits | 20 credits | 50% | All 20 failed credits | Up to 20 credits (50%) |
| **Example 2** | 40 credits | 24 credits | 60% | All 24 failed credits | Up to 16 credits (40%) |
| **Example 3** | 44 credits | 22 credits | 50% | All 22 failed credits | Up to 22 credits (50%) |

*Principle:*
*Forward progression is always limited to the remaining feasible percentage, such that the total academic load remains realistic, recoverable, and academically sound.*

### 5.4 Advanced Course Registration (Conditional)

Where:

**5.4.1** Timetable feasibility exists, and

**5.4.2** All prerequisites are fully satisfied,

A student may be permitted to register for advanced-level courses only as part of the approved Individual Study Plan.

Such registration:

**5.4.3** Requires **explicit academic approval**

**5.4.4** Shall **not** be construed as an entitlement

**5.4.5** Remains subject to revision or withdrawal based on academic performance

## 6. Mandatory Academic Advising & Individual Study Plan (ISP)

### 6.1 Advising Requirement

Every student placed on Academic Year Back shall undergo mandatory academic advising with the **Programme Lead / Cluster Head**.

The advising process shall review:

**6.1.1** Failed courses and recovery attempt status

**6.1.2** Prerequisite blocks and sequencing constraints

**6.1.3** Credit feasibility per semester

**6.1.4** Impact on **expected graduation timeline**

### 6.2 Individual Study Plan (ISP)

An Individual Study Plan (ISP) shall be created for each Academic Year Back student, specifying:

**6.2.1** Backlog courses to be cleared semester-wise

**6.2.2** New courses (if any) approved for registration

**6.2.3** Semester-wise credit load

**6.2.4** Impact on graduation timeline and Programme duration

The ISP shall be:

**6.2.5** Approved and signed by the Programme Lead / Cluster Head

**6.2.6** Submitted to **the Academic Planning & Operations (APO)**

**6.2.7** Used for **controlled, manual registration in the ERP**

No deviation from the approved ISP shall be permitted without **Dean-level approval.**

## 7. Student–Parent / Guardian Undertaking

As a **mandatory condition** for registration under Academic Year Back:

**7.1** The **student and parent / guardian** shall jointly sign an Undertaking, acknowledging:

**7.1.1** Possible delay in graduation

**7.1.2** Additional financial implications (including Summer Semester, Directed Reading, or extended duration) *

**7.1.3** Possibility of Increased academic workload and reduced flexibility

**7.1.4** Non-entitlement to concessions beyond this Policy

**7.2** No registration under Academic Year Back shall be processed without the signed Undertaking.

* Regular course repeat beyond the prescribed Programme duration (N) shall be subject to extended-duration fees, as notified by the University.

## 8. Academic Rigour & Progression Principles

The Academic Year Back framework operates on the following non-negotiable principles:

**8.1** Academic backlogs must be cleared before full progression

**8.2** Recovery and progression pathways are **more rigorous than regular progression**

**8.3** Forward movement is **conditional, capped, and closely monitored**

## 9. Governance & Responsibilities

| Stakeholder | Responsibility |
|---|---|
| **Programme Lead / Cluster Head** | Academic counselling, ISP approval |
| **Academic Planning & Operations (APO)** | ERP control, manual registration |
| **Dean** | Academic oversight |
| **Student** | Compliance with ISP and policy |
| **Parent / Guardian** | Acknowledgement of implications |

## 10. Records, Audit & Compliance

**10.1** All Academic Year Back cases shall be recorded in the ERP

**10.2** **Records** shall be retained for a minimum of five (5) years

**10.3** Deviations from approved ISP require Dean-level approval

**10.4** This Policy operates strictly within UGC maximum Programme duration norms (N + 2 + 1)

## 11. Review, Interpretation & Amendment

This Policy shall be:

**11.1** Reviewed annually by the **Academic Council**

**11.2** Amended as required to align with regulatory or institutional changes

The University reserves the right to **interpret and implement this Policy** in alignment with approved academic frameworks and regulatory requirements.
All interpretations issued by the University shall be **final and binding.**

# SUPPLEMENTARY EXAMINATION POLICY

**(Policy Code: AG-06)**

*This Policy shall come into force* ***with immediate effect****.*

## 1. Purpose

**1.1** The Supplementary Examination Policy establishes a **structured, time-bound academic recovery mechanism** for students who:

**1.1.1** Have failed a course due to **academic reasons**, or

**1.1.2** Were **eligible but unable to appear** in the End-Term Examination for valid academic reasons, or

**1.1.3** Have passed a course and are **seeking grade improvement**, where permitted,

**1.2** While ensuring **academic rigour, transparency, fairness, auditability, and timely academic progression**.

**1.3** This Policy operates within the framework of the **UPES Academic Progression Framework** and **Academic Recovery Pathways (ARP)**

## 2. Scope

**2.1** This Policy applies to:

**2.1.1** All full-time Undergraduate and Postgraduate students of UPES

**2.1.2** All Schools and Programmes

**2.1.3** Only those courses for which **Supplementary Examination windows are formally notified** by the Controller of Examinations (CoE)

## 3. Definitions

| Term | Definition |
|---|---|
| **Supplementary Examination** | A re-examination opportunity for eligible students to clear a course by reappearing in the End-Term Examination component. |
| **Improvement Examination** | Use of the Supplementary Examination mechanism by eligible students to improve a previously awarded passing grade, governed by the Grade Improvement Policy. |
| **Debarred** | A student barred from the End-Term Examination due to attendance below 75% or other eligibility restrictions. |
| **Theory Course** | A course assessed through a written End-Term Examination. |
| **Non-Theory Course** | Courses assessed through labs, projects, studios, internships, dissertations, jury-based or practice-based evaluation. |

## 4. Eligibility Criteria

### 4.1 Supplementary Examination –

A student may register for a Supplementary Examination **only if all the following conditions are met**:

**4.1.1** The student has been **awarded an F grade**, and

**4.1.2** The student **was not debarred** from the End-Term Examination, and

**4.1.3** One of the following applies:

**4.1.3.1** Failed the End-Term Examination due to academic reasons, **or**

**4.1.3.2** Was **eligible but could not appear** in the End-Term Examination, and

**4.1.4** Minimum **75% attendance** requirement was satisfied, and

**4.1.5** **Continuous Assessment (CA) > 0**, and CA is mathematically sufficient to clear the course after End-Term evaluation, and

**4.1.6** The student is within the **permitted recovery attempt limits** under the Academic Progression Framework.

### 4.2 Cases Where Supplementary Examination Is NOT Permitted

| Case | Applicable Pathway |
|---|---|
| **Debarred due to attendance (<75%)** | Summer Semester / Directed Reading / Regular Repeat |
| **CA = 0 or CA too low to mathematically clear** | Summer Semester / Directed Reading / Regular Repeat |
| **Academic misconduct penalty** | Governed by Academic Integrity Policy |

### 4.3 Supplementary Examination for Grade Improvement

Students who have **successfully passed a course** may use the Supplementary Examination **for grade improvement**, subject to the following:

**4.3.1** The student must be **eligible under the UPES Grade Improvement Policy**

**4.3.2** The student must be **currently enrolled and academically active**

**4.3.3** All conditions, limits, transcript treatment, and CGPA implications shall be governed **exclusively by the Grade Improvement Policy**

**4.4** Supplementary Examination **does not create an independent entitlement** for grade improvement beyond what is permitted under the Grade Improvement Policy.

## 5. Assessment Scope & Examination Structure

**5.1** Supplementary / Improvement Examination evaluates **only the End-Term component**

**5.2** Continuous Assessment (CA / IA / MCE) marks **cannot be improved**

**5.3** The Supplementary End-Term score **replaces the earlier End-Term score**

**5.4** No grade capping shall be applied

**5.5** Best valid academic performance shall be awarded

**5.6 Duration of Supplementary Examination:** as notified by CoE

## 6. Weightage Rules Based on Original Course Attempt Period

| Original Course Attempt | Supplementary Evaluation Model | Remarks |
|---|---|---|
| **Before July 2023** | 100% Supplementary Exam | Single exam determines result |
| **July 2023 onwards** | End-Term component only (30%) | CA & MCE carried forward |

**Note:**
If CA / MCE marks are mathematically insufficient to clear the course, Supplementary registration shall **not be permitted**, and the student must opt for **Summer Semester / Directed Reading / Regular Repeat**.

## 7. Attempt Limits & Academic Progression Alignment

**7.1** Supplementary Examination constitutes **one recovery attempt** under the Academic Recovery Pathways.

**7.2** A student is permitted a **maximum of two (2) recovery attempts per course**, through any combination of:

**7.2.1** Supplementary Examination

**7.2.2** Summer Semester

**7.2.3** Directed Reading (DR)

**7.2.4** Regular Course Repeat

**7.3** Where a student has failed a course and exhausted the maximum number of permitted recovery attempts under the Academic Recovery Pathways, Regular Course Repeat shall be the only permissible mechanism to continue attempts to clear the course and shall be mandatory in nature.

## 8. Supplementary Examination Cycles

| Cycle | Period | Applicability |
|---|---|---|
| **Cycle 1** | July | Combined Odd & Even Semester Courses |
| **Cycle 2** | Special Cycle | Graduating Batch only |

## 9. Registration & Administration

| Item | Provision |
|---|---|
| **Registration Mode** | Online via Student Portal / ERP |
| **Eligibility Validation** | System + CoE verification |

| | |
|---|---|
| **Registration Window** | Opens post result declaration |
| **Fee** | ₹2,000 per course (subject to University revision) |
| **Refund / Withdrawal** | Not permitted |
| **Admit Card** | Mandatory for exam entry |

## 10. Result Processing & Moderation

**10.1** Supplementary / Improvement results shall be processed and declared by the CoE

**10.2** Results shall undergo moderation as per University Moderation Policy

**10.3** Final approval shall rest with the University Result Board

**10.4** Transcript notation shall reflect the attempt in a **neutral, non-stigmatic manner**, as per University policy

## 11. Student Responsibilities & Advisory

**11.1** Students shall:

**11.1.1** Track official notifications, eligibility criteria, and deadlines

**11.1.2** Verify mathematical feasibility of clearance before registration

**11.1.3** Seek guidance from Academic Mentor / Course Coordinator / Exam Helpdesk where unsure

**11.2 Important Advisory:**

Applying for or appearing in a Supplementary Examination **does not guarantee eligibility**. Incorrect or ineligible registration shall still be **counted as a recovery attempt and shall be non-refundable**.

**11.3** All Supplementary Examinations are conducted **offline**, and physical presence is mandatory.

## 12. Governance & Accountability

**Revision & Discretion Clause**

The University reserves the right to revise fees, examination rules, eligibility conditions, timelines, and operational modalities related to Supplementary Examinations in accordance with regulatory requirements, academic considerations, or administrative exigencies. All revisions shall be notified through official University communication channels and shall be binding.

# DIRECTED READING (DR) POLICY

**(Policy Code: AG-07)**

*This Policy shall come into force* ***with immediate effect****.*

## 1. Purpose

**1.1** Directed Reading (DR) is a **structured, faculty-supervised academic recovery mechanism** that enables eligible students to complete a failed or debarred course through a personalised learning plan, in lieu of regular classroom-based delivery.

**1.2** Directed Reading:

**1.2.1** Operates as part of UPES's **Academic Recovery Pathways (ARP)**

**1.2.2** Is designed to ensure **no dilution of academic standards**, with **structured and closely monitored engagement**, and **learning outcomes exceeding those of regular course delivery**.

**1.3** Directed Reading is **not an entitlement** and shall be permitted only through a defined academic approval process.

## 2. Scope

**2.1** This policy applies to:

**2.1.1** All full-time **Undergraduate and Postgraduate** students of UPES

**2.1.2** Eligible courses approved for Directed Reading in each academic cycle

**2.2** DR offerings shall be limited to courses approved based on **academic feasibility, faculty availability, and recovery need**, and shall not operate as a parallel or substitute delivery mode.

## 3. Definitions

| Term | Definition |
|---|---|
| **Directed Reading (DR)** | A supervised academic engagement where a student completes a course through an approved learning plan, weekly faculty interaction, and formal assessment |
| **Academic Recovery Pathways (ARP)** | Institutionally approved mechanisms for academic recovery, including Supplementary Examination, Summer Semester, Directed Reading, Regular Course Repeat, Substitution and Academic Year Back. |
| **Debarred Student** | A student not permitted to appear for the End-Term Examination due to attendance below 75% |
| **Academic Failure** | A student who failed a course academically despite meeting attendance eligibility (≥75%) |

## 4. Eligibility for Directed Reading

### 4.1 Academic Failure (Attendance ≥75%)

A student may opt for Directed Reading if the student:

**4.1.1** Has received an **Ab grade** with attendance ≥75%, or

**4.1.2** Has failed the **Supplementary Examination**

### 4.2 Debarred Students (Attendance <75%)

A student who has been **debarred due to attendance shortage (<75%)** and awarded an F (Debarred) grade:

**4.2.1** May opt for **either Directed Reading OR Summer Semester** to clear the debarred course

**4.2.2** Is **not eligible for Supplementary Examination** for the debarred course

**4.2.3** Must clear the debarred course before registering for any course where it is a prerequisite

The choice between Directed Reading and Summer Semester shall be exercised by the student, subject to academic feasibility and availability.

### 4.3 Attempt Limits and Academic Standing

**Directed Reading may be permitted only after a student has made at least one regular attempt in the course**, where a *regular attempt* means **formal registration for the course in a regular semester with full teaching–learning and assessment exposure**, irrespective of the final grade outcome.

Directed Reading shall constitute **one (1) recovery attempt** under the Academic Recovery Pathways.

A maximum of **three (3) total attempts per course** is permitted across the Programme, inclusive of:

**4.3.1** Regular Semester (first attempt)

**4.3.2** Any two (2) recovery attempts through a combination of:

**4.3.2.1** Supplementary Examination

**4.3.2.2** Summer Semester

**4.3.2.3** Directed Reading

**4.3.2.4** Regular Course Repeat

**4.3.2.5** Substitution of an Elective/Optional course to clear a 'F' grade

**Where a student has failed a course and exhausted the maximum number of permitted recovery attempts under the Academic Recovery Pathways, Regular**

**Course Repeat shall be the only permissible mechanism to continue attempts to clear the course and shall be mandatory in nature.**

## 5. Restrictions and Limits

| Parameter | Rule |
|---|---|
| **Maximum DR per student** | Registration for Directed Reading (DR) courses shall be permitted only up to a maximum of **15% of the total current semester credit requirement of the Programme. Where** the 15% calculation results in a fractional credit value, the maximum permissible DR credits shall be determined by **standard mathematical rounding to the nearest whole credit**, with values of **0.50 and above rounded upward** and values **below 0.50 rounded downward**. |
| **Faculty supervision limit** | 2 DR course per faculty per cycle |
| **Eligible course types** | Theory or Theory + Lab (where lab outcomes can be mapped to assignments) |
| **Not permitted for** | Pure labs, studios, workshops, internships, capstones, dissertations |
| **Engagement requirement** | Minimum **75% structured academic engagement** |
| **Failure in DR** | **Failure in Directed Reading shall be treated as exhaustion of one recovery attempt.**<br>Further recovery options, if any, shall be governed by the remaining attempt eligibility under the Academic Progression Framework. Where recovery attempts are exhausted, the student shall be governed by repeat provisions as applicable. |

## 6. Assessment Structure

**6.1** Directed Reading follows **fresh evaluation**, aligned with regular semester standards.

| Component | Weightage |
|---|---|
| **Continuous Assessment (Assignments /Mid-Course Evaluations)** | 70% |
| **End-Term Examination / Viva / Final Evaluation** | 30% |

**6.2 Assessment Rules:**

**6.2.1** The assessment weightage for Directed Reading shall follow a 70:30 structure

**6.2.2** No internal or midcourse evaluation marks from previous attempts shall be carried forward

**6.2.3** Assessments must map to **Course Outcomes (COs)**

**6.2.4** The assessment plan must be approved by the **School Cluster Head**

**6.2.5** End-Term evaluation shall be conducted in the **next available examination cycle** as notified by the Controller of Examinations

**6.2.6** **Assessments should be more rigorous than the regular course**

## 7. Fees

**7.1** **₹3,000 per credit**

**7.2** Full fee payment is mandatory at the time of registration

**Refunds**

**7.3** Refunds shall be permitted **only** in cases of:

**7.3.1** University-led cancellation of DR approval

**7.3.2** Verified administrative or payment error

**7.4** No refund shall be permitted for voluntary withdrawal by the student.

## 8. Documentation and Records

All DR-related records—including applications, learning plans, attendance logs, assessments, and results—shall be:

**8.1** Maintained in ERP / LMS

**8.2** Retained for a minimum of **five (5) years**

**8.3** Subject to audit and quality review

## 9. Communication

The University shall notify Directed Reading application timelines, procedures, and eligibility conditions at the beginning of each semester through official University communication channels. **Communication on DR application process to initiate at the beginning of the semester by office of the VC/ Pro-VC/ Vice Pro-vost.**

## 10. Policy Review

This policy shall be reviewed **annually** by the Academic Council and updated as required to remain aligned with:

**10.1** Academic Recovery Pathways

**10.2** Academic Progression Framework

**10.3** Regulatory and operational requirements

## 11. Governance & Accountability

The University reserves the right to **revise fees, examination rules, eligibility conditions, timelines, and operational modalities** related to Directed Reading at any time, based on regulatory requirements, academic considerations, or administrative exigencies. Such revisions shall be notified through official University communication channels and shall be binding on all students.

# SUMMER SEMESTER POLICY

**(Policy Code: AG-08)**

*This Policy shall come into force* ***with immediate effect****.*

## 1. Purpose

**1.1** The Summer Semester is an intensive additional academic term designed to support **timely academic progression and structured academic recovery**, without dilution of academic standards.

**1.2** It enables eligible students to:

**1.2.1** Clear failed or debarred courses

**1.2.2** Recover from academic failure without delaying progression

**1.2.3** Fulfil prerequisite requirements for advanced coursework

**1.2.4** Progress academically within approved University frameworks

**1.3** The Summer Semester functions as an integral component of UPES's **Academic Recovery Pathways (ARP)** and, where applicable, as an **approved mode for Grade Improvement**, subject to separate governing policies.

**1.4** Participation in the Summer Semester is **not automatic** and is subject to eligibility conditions, attempt limits, academic feasibility, and course availability.

## 2. Scope

**2.1** This Policy applies to:

**2.1.1** All full-time Undergraduate and Postgraduate students of UPES

**2.1.2** All Schools and Programmes where Summer Semester offerings are formally notified

**2.2** For Programmes governed by statutory or professional regulatory bodies (including but not limited to the **Bar Council of India (BCI)** and **Pharmacy Council of India (PCI)**), the applicable regulatory norms shall **prevail in case of any inconsistency** with this Policy.

## 3. Eligibility

### 3.1 Debarred Students (Attendance < 75%)

Students debarred from the End-Term Examination due to attendance shortage (<75%) and awarded an **F grade**:

**3.1.1** May be considered for **Summer Semester** or **Directed Reading (DR)** or **Regular Repeat** to clear the debarred course

**3.1.2** Are **not eligible** for Supplementary Examination for the debarred course

**3.1.3** Must clear the debarred course before registering for any course for which it is a prerequisite

Enrolment is subject to:

**3.1.4** Availability of remaining recovery attempts under ARP

**3.1.5** Course availability and academic feasibility

**3.1.6** Institutional approval

**3.2** The choice between Summer Semester, Regular Repeat and DR shall be exercised by the student, subject to course availability and eligibility conditions.

### 3.3 Academic Failure with Eligibility (Attendance ≥ 75%)

Students who receive an **F grade** despite meeting attendance eligibility may be considered for the Summer Semester:

**3.3.1** After failing the regular End-Term attempt

**3.3.2** After failing a Supplementary Examination

**3.3.3** To manage prerequisite progression

Enrollment remains subject to:

**3.3.4** Recovery attempt limits prescribed under ARP

**3.3.5** Course availability and institutional feasibility

### 3.4 Grade Improvement (Through Summer Semester)

**3.4.1** Students who apply **for grade improvement under the UPES Grade Improvement Policy** may utilise the Summer Semester as **one of the approved modes** for grade improvement.

**3.4.2** All rules, conditions, eligibility criteria, attempt limits, transcript treatment, and CGPA implications related to grade improvement shall be governed **exclusively** by the **UPES Grade Improvement Policy**.

**3.4.3** The Summer Semester does **not** create any additional entitlement, relaxation, or special consideration for grade improvement beyond what is permitted under the Grade Improvement Policy and remains subject to course availability and academic feasibility.

### 3.5 Advanced Learners (Acceleration Pathway)

Students may utilise the Summer Semester to:

**3.5.1** Earn credits in advance

**3.5.2** Complete prerequisite chains early

Such enrollment shall remain subject to:

**3.5.3** Prerequisite enforcement

**3.5.4** Programme structure requirements

**3.5.5** **Maximum Programme duration norms (N + 2 + 1)**

**3.5.6** Applicable academic and regulatory constraints

## 4. Assessment Rules

**4.1** All Summer Semester courses shall follow **fresh evaluation**

**4.2** No Internal Assessment (IA), Continuous Assessment (CA), or Mid-Course Evaluation (MCE) marks from previous attempts shall be carried forward

**4.3** Students must complete all prescribed assessment components anew

**4.4** Assessment structure and academic standards shall be **identical to regular semester norms**, including:

**4.5** Continuous Assessment (as prescribed)

**4.6** Mid-Course Evaluation

**4.7** End-Term Examination

Moderation and result processing shall follow standard University examination regulations.

## 5. Course Load Limits

**5.1**

| Parameter | Rule |
|---|---|
| **Maximum courses per student** | 2 |
| **Credit load** | Not counted within the regular semester credit limit |

**5.2** Enrollment is subject to:

**5.2.1** Prerequisite compliance

**5.2.2** Applicable recovery or improvement attempt limits

## 6. Attempt Limits

**6.1** For recovery purposes:

Each course permits:

**6.1.1** **One (1) Regular Attempt**, and

**6.1.2** **A maximum of two (2) Recovery Attempts** through approved recovery pathways, including Summer Semester

**6.2** Where a student has failed a course and exhausted the maximum number of permitted recovery attempts under the Academic Recovery Pathways, Regular Course Repeat shall be the only permissible mechanism to continue attempts to clear the course and shall be mandatory in nature.

**6.3** For grade improvement attempts undertaken through the Summer Semester, attempt counting and eligibility shall be governed **solely by the Grade Improvement Policy** and shall not override recovery attempt limits applicable to failed courses.

## 7. Fees

**7.1** ₹3,000 per credit

**7.2** Full fee payment is mandatory at the time of registration

**7.3** Partial or delayed payments are not permitted

**Refunds**

**7.4** Refunds shall be permitted **only** in the following cases:

**7.4.1** Course cancellation by the University due to insufficient enrolment

**7.4.2** Verified administrative or payment error

**7.5** No refunds shall be permitted for voluntary withdrawal by the student.

## 8. Attendance Requirement

**8.1** Minimum **75% attendance** in Summer Semester classes is mandatory

**8.2** Failure to meet attendance requirements results in debarment from the Summer Semester End-Term Examination

**8.3** Such courses may be cleared subsequently **only if recovery attempts remain available**, through:

**8.3.1** Regular Repeat in a regular semester

**8.3.2** Directed Reading (where permitted)

**8.3.3** A future Summer Semester offering (if eligible and offered)

## 9. Course Offerings & Availability

**9.1** Courses shall be offered based on student demand and academic feasibility

**9.2** The University reserves the right to cancel courses that do not meet viability criteria

**9.3** A student may enrol in a **maximum of two courses per Summer Semester cycle**

## 10. SRIJAN / Mandatory Internship Adjustment

**10.1** Students enrolled in the Summer Semester may:

**10.1.1** Defer **SRIJAN / mandatory internship** to the next available cycle without penalty, subject to University guidelines

## 11. Implications of Opting Out of the Summer Semester

**11.1** Students opting not to enrol in the Summer Semester and instead repeating courses in a regular semester should note that:

**11.1.1** Timetable conflicts with subsequent batches may arise

**11.1.2** Examination schedules may overlap

**11.1.3** Prerequisite restrictions may delay registration in advanced courses

**11.1.4** Graduation and placement timelines may be impacted

**11.2** While no additional fee is charged for repeating a course in a regular semester, progression delays may have academic and financial consequences.

## 12. Governance & Accountability

The University reserves the right to revise fees, eligibility conditions, examination rules, timelines, and operational modalities related to the Summer Semester in line with regulatory requirements, academic considerations, or administrative exigencies. All such revisions shall be notified through official University communication channels and shall be binding.

| Stakeholder | Responsibility |
|---|---|
| **Controller of Examinations** | Scheduling, conduct, and result processing |
| **Schools / Programme Offices** | Student communication and academic coordination |
| **Students** | Compliance, timely registration, and adherence to rules |

# REGULAR COURSE REPEAT POLICY

**(Policy Code: AG-09)**

*This Policy shall come into force* ***with immediate effect****.*

## 1. Purpose

**1.1** The Regular Course Repeat Policy establishes a structured academic mechanism that enables a student to **re-enrol in and repeat a course through the regular semester teaching–learning process** in order to:

**1.1.1** Clear a **failed course**, or

**1.1.2** Improve a **previously earned grade**, where permitted

**1.2** This Policy:

**1.2.1** Functions as a **course-level Academic Recovery Pathway** within the University's academic governance framework

**1.2.2** Preserves **full academic rigour** through mandatory re-engagement with all instructional, attendance, and assessment components

**1.2.3** Serves as the **baseline recovery option**, without facilitation, relaxation, or special accommodation

**1.2.4** Operates in alignment with the **UPES Academic Progression Framework**, **Academic Recovery Pathways (ARP)**

**1.3** Regular Course Repeat is designed to ensure academic integrity, progression discipline, and compliance with maximum Programme duration norms.

## 2. Scope

**2.1** This Policy applies to:

**2.1.1** All full-time Undergraduate and Postgraduate students across Schools and Programmes at UPES

**2.1.2** All credit-bearing courses offered through the **regular semester mode**

**2.2** For Programmes governed by statutory or professional regulatory bodies (including but not limited to the **Bar Council of India (BCI)** and **Pharmacy Council of India (PCI)**), the applicable regulatory norms shall **prevail in the event of any inconsistency** with this Policy.

## 3. Positioning within Academic Recovery Pathways

**3.1** Regular Course Repeat is categorised as:

**3.1.1** A **course-level academic recovery mechanism**, and

**3.1.2** A **permitted mechanism for grade improvement**, subject to eligibility conditions, attempt limits, and progression rules

**3.2** Regular Course Repeat represents the **baseline academic recovery option**, requiring full compliance with all regular academic rules, processes, and expectations.

**3.3** It is distinct from **facilitated recovery pathways**, such as:

**3.3.1** Supplementary Examination (assessment-only recovery)

**3.3.2** Summer Semester (condensed instructional recovery)

**3.3.3** Directed Reading (faculty-supervised recovery outside the regular class structure)

**3.4** Facilitated recovery pathways may be advised where feasible to support progression efficiency and academic load management. However, **Regular Course Repeat remains an equally valid and academically rigorous recovery pathway**, governed strictly by this Policy.

## 4. Eligibility for Regular Course Repeat

A student may opt for or be required to repeat a course through Regular Course Repeat under one or more of the following circumstances:

**4.1** To clear a **failed course** through full regular semester delivery

**4.2** To **improve a previously earned grade**, where permitted

**4.3** When Supplementary Examination, Summer Semester, or Directed Reading is:

**4.3.1** Not available, or

**4.3.2** Not opted for by the student, or

**4.3.3** Not permitted under applicable rules

**4.4** Where academic progression is blocked due to **prerequisite dependencies**

**4.5** As part of an approved **Academic Year Back** or structured recovery decision

**4.6** Where the student has **exhausted the maximum number of permitted recovery attempts** under the Academic Recovery Pathways

Eligibility is subject to:

**4.7** Availability of the course in the regular semester

**4.8** Compliance with semester credit limits, registration rules, and Programme duration norms

## 5. Nature of Regular Course Repeat

When a student opts for or is assigned Regular Course Repeat:

**5.1** The student shall **re-register for the course as a regular student**

**5.2** All components of assessment, **Continuous Assessment, Mid-Course Evaluation, and End-Term Examination,** shall be undertaken **afresh**

**5.3** No internal assessment marks, attendance, or examination scores from previous attempts shall be carried forward

**5.4** The student shall comply fully with:

**5.4.1** Attendance requirements

**5.4.2** Assessment timelines

**5.4.3** Academic conduct and integrity norms applicable to the course

**5.5** Regular Course Repeat restores the student to the **standard academic conditions** of the course, without exception.

## 6. Operational Considerations

**6.1** As Regular Course Repeat requires full participation in the regular semester:

**6.1.1** Students may experience **timetable clashes** with other registered courses

**6.1.2** Academic workload may increase, subject to the **maximum semester credit limit of 27 credits (***For **BCI/PCI-regulated programmes**, where the prescribed semester load exceeds 24 credits, an additional **credit overload of up to 15%** of the semester's credit requirement may be permitted*.)

**6.1.3** Progression may be delayed due to prerequisite sequencing or curriculum structure

**6.2** The University **does not guarantee clash-free timetabling** for courses repeated through the regular semester.

**6.3** Students are therefore advised to carefully evaluate feasibility and to prioritise facilitated recovery pathways **where available and eligible**.

6.4 The student shall complete registration for the Regular Course Repeat **within one (1) week from the commencement of the semester**.

## 7. Credit, Grade & Transcript Treatment

**7.1** Credits for the course shall be awarded **only upon successful completion** of the Regular Course Repeat

**7.2** All failed, debarred, or ineligible attempts shall be retained in internal academic records for traceability and audit

**7.3** Grade replacement and CGPA treatment shall be governed by the **Academic Records & Transcript Philosophy**

**7.4** Transcript representation shall be **neutral and non-stigmatic**, reflecting final academic outcomes in accordance with University policy

## 8. Fees & Registration

**8.1** Regular Course Repeat shall **not attract any special recovery fee**

**8.2** Applicable tuition and semester fees shall follow the **standard fee structure** for regular enrolment

**8.3** Students must complete formal registration for the repeated course within **notified timelines**

**8.4** Failure to register appropriately may result in **loss of the recovery opportunity** for that semester.

## 9. Attempt Applicability & Recovery Alignment

Regular Course Repeat is a **mandatory academic reset mechanism** undertaken **after exhaustion of permitted recovery attempts** under the Academic Recovery Pathways (ARP).

**9.1** Accordingly:

Each course permits:

**9.1.1** **One (1) Regular Attempt**, and

**9.1.2** **A maximum of two (2) Recovery Attempts** through approved recovery pathways

**9.1.3** Upon exhaustion of recovery attempts, the student shall be mandatorily required to **repeat the course in regular mode**

**9.1.4** All prior attempts remain part of the academic record and are considered for progression decisions within the **maximum Programme duration (N + 2 + 1)** prescribed by the University

## 10. Course Repeat for Grade Improvement

**10.1** Students who are eligible for grade improvement may repeat a course in regular mode **only in accordance with the UPES Grade Improvement Policy**.

**10.2** All rules, eligibility conditions, attempt limits, fee requirements, transcript treatment, and CGPA implications related to grade improvement shall be governed **exclusively** by the Grade Improvement Policy.

**10.3** Nothing in this Policy shall be construed as creating an **additional, independent, or automatic entitlement** for grade improvement through Regular Course Repeat.

## 11. Authority & Governance

Approval, oversight, and implementation of Regular Course Repeat shall rest with the **designated academic authorities** as notified by the University.

**11.1** All decisions shall be:

**11.1.1** Rule-based

**11.1.2** Documented

**11.1.3** Communicated formally to the student

**11.2** This Policy shall be applied **uniformly across all Schools and Programmes**.

## 12. Review & Amendment

**12.1** This Policy shall be reviewed periodically to ensure alignment with:

**12.1.1** UGC regulations

**12.1.2** NEP 2020 provisions

**12.1.3** Institutional academic strategy and progression philosophy

**12.2** The University may revise the rules, conditions, or fees associated with this Policy, subject to applicable regulatory provisions. Such revisions shall be communicated through official University notifications and shall normally apply **prospectively**.

# COURSE SUBSTITUTION POLICY

**(Policy Code: AG-10)**

*This Policy shall come into force* ***with immediate effect***

## 1. Purpose

**1.1** The Course Substitution Policy defines the conditions under which a student at UPES may substitute an **optional / elective course** with another **approved course of the same category**, in order to:

**1.1.1** Clear an **F grade** in an optional / elective course

**1.1.2** Improve an **earlier passing grade** in an optional / elective course (limited provision)

**1.1.3** Support timely academic progression **without compromising academic integrity, equivalence, or regulatory compliance**

**1.2** This Policy operates within the University's **Academic Recovery Pathways** and shall be read in conjunction with the Academic Progression Framework and the UPES Academic Handbook.

## 2. Scope & Applicability

### 2.1 Applicable To

**2.1.1** All **Undergraduate and Postgraduate** students of UPES

**2.1.2** Only **optional / elective courses**, including:

**2.1.2.1** Major Electives

**2.1.2.2** Exploratory Courses

**2.1.2.3** School for Life (SFL) courses

### 2.2 Not Applicable To

**2.3** **Mandatory / Core courses**, which **cannot be substituted** under any circumstance

## 3. Definitions

| Term | Definition |
|---|---|
| **Course Substitution** | Replacement of an approved optional course with another approved course of the same category |
| **Optional Course** | Any course not designated as mandatory for degree completion |
| **Academic Recovery Pathways (ARP)** | University-approved mechanisms for clearing academic deficiencies, including Supplementary Examination, Summer Semester, Directed Reading, Regular Course Repeat, Course Substitution, and Academic Year Back |
| **Clearing an F Grade** | Removal of an F grade by earning a passing grade (C or higher) |
| **Grade Improvement** | Replacement of a previously earned passing grade with a higher grade |

## 4. Core Principles

**4.1** **Mandatory / Core courses shall not be substituted** and must be cleared only by repeating the same course or through other eligible recovery pathways.

**4.2** **Only optional courses** (Major Elective, Exploratory, SfL) are eligible for substitution.

**4.3** Course substitution is a **one-time academic replacement** and permanently replaces the original course in the student's academic record.

**4.4** Once a course is substituted, the original course:

**4.4.1** Cannot be repeated

**4.4.2** Cannot be improved

**4.5** Course substitution shall be subject to **academic equivalence review**, seat availability, and approval through prescribed authorities.

**4.6** **Course substitution shall be counted within maximum attempt limits**, as follows:

**4.6.1** One (1) regular attempt and up to two (2) recovery attempts are permitted per course.

**4.6.2** Upon exhaustion of permitted attempts, the student shall be **mandatorily required to repeat the course in Regular Repeat mode with a subsequent batch**, as per applicable policies.

## 5. Eligibility for Course Substitution

A student may apply for course substitution only if **all** the following conditions are met:

**5.1** The course to be substituted is **optional / elective**

**5.2** The substitution is sought for:

**5.2.1** Clearing an **F grade**, or

**5.2.2** **Grade improvement**, subject to limits prescribed in Section 7

**5.3** The proposed substitute course belongs to the **same category**, as below:

**5.3.1** Major Elective → Major Elective

**5.3.2** Exploratory → Exploratory

**5.3.3** SfL → SfL

**5.4** **Seat availability** exists in the proposed substitute course

**5.5** **Academic equivalence** is established and formally approved

## 6. Course Substitution for Clearing an F Grade

### 6.1 Substitution after Academic Failure

If a student receives an **F grade** in an optional course and chooses not to repeat the same course, the student may opt for course substitution.

In such cases:

**6.1.1** The substituted course must be of the **same category**

**6.1.2** The grade earned in the substituted course **replaces the F grade**

**6.1.3** The substituted course:

**6.1.3.1** Counts toward credit requirements

**6.1.3.2** Is included in CGPA calculation

**6.2 Number of Substitutions for F-Grade Clearance**

**6.3** There shall be **no numerical cap** on the number of course substitutions permitted **solely for clearing F grades**, provided that:

**6.3.1** Each substitution complies with this Policy

**6.3.2** Academic equivalence is approved

**6.3.3** Programme duration limits and attempt limits are not violated

**6.4** This provision aligns with the University's approved Academic Recovery Pathways and institutional approvals.

## 7. Course Substitution for Grade Improvement

Course substitution for **grade improvement** shall be governed by the following strict conditions:

**7.1 Only one (1) course substitution for grade improvement** is permitted during the **entire duration of the Programme**.

**7.2** A course substituted for grade improvement:

**7.2.1** Cannot be substituted again

**7.2.2** Cannot be repeated or further improved through any recovery mechanism

**7.3** The grade earned in the substituted course:

**7.3.1** Replaces the earlier grade for CGPA calculation

**7.3.2** Appears on all subsequent transcripts

**7.4** The substituted course:

**7.4.1** Counts toward minimum credit requirements

**7.4.2** Is included within the maximum permissible semester credit load

**7.5** Approval is subject to:

**7.5.1** Seat availability

**7.5.2** Academic equivalence

## 8. Relationship with Attempt Limits & Progression Rules

**8.1** Course substitution **does not reset, bypass, or extend** the maximum number of permitted attempts per course.

**8.2** Failed attempts in the original course **remain part of the student's academic history** for progression, Year Back, and exit evaluations.

## 9. Grading & Transcript Treatment

**9.1** The grade earned in the substituted course:

**9.1.1** Replaces the original course grade for CGPA calculation

**9.1.2** Appears on all subsequent transcripts

**9.2** The original course:

**9.2.1** Is marked as **"Substituted"**

**9.2.2** Does not count toward credits or CGPA

## 10. Attendance & Assessment Requirements

**10.1** Students must meet **full attendance (minimum 75%)** and assessment requirements of the substituted course.

**10.2** **No carry-forward** of internal assessments or examinations from the original course is permitted.

**10.3** The substituted course shall be treated as a **fresh academic registration**.

## 11. Approval & Workflow

| Stage | Authority |
|---|---|
| **Student Application** | Student |
| **Eligibility Verification** | Programme Lead |
| **Academic Equivalence Review** | Cluster Head |
| **Final Approval** | Dean of School |
| **Registration & Record Update** | APO / CoE |

Approval is subject to academic equivalence, seat availability, and compliance with Programme structure.

## 12. Fees

**12.1** Course substitution shall **not attract any additional or separate fee**.

**12.2** The substituted course shall be treated as a **regular course registration**, and the applicable charges, if any, shall be **included within the regular semester fee structure**, as notified by the University.

**12.3** No standalone or special substitution fee shall be levied.

## 13. Policy Governance & Review

**13.1** This Policy shall be reviewed periodically to ensure alignment with:

**13.1.1** UPES Academic Handbook

**13.1.2** NEP 2020 principles

**13.1.3** UGC regulations

Institutional academic strategy

**13.2** The University reserves the right to revise eligibility conditions, procedural requirements, or applicable fees, with due notification.

# GRADE IMPROVEMENT POLICY

**(Policy Code: AG-11)**

This Policy shall come into force **with immediate effect.**

## 1. Purpose

**1.1** The Grade Improvement Policy defines the conditions under which a student at UPES may seek to **improve a previously earned passing grade** in an eligible course, without compromising academic rigour, progression discipline, or institutional standards.

**1.2** This policy aims to:

**1.2.1** Provide a **limited and regulated opportunity** for grade improvement

**1.2.2** Prevent repeated or strategic grade enhancement attempts

**1.2.3** Ensure transparency in grading, transcript treatment, and fees

**1.2.4** Operate in alignment with the **Academic Progression Framework** and **UGC norms**

## 2. Scope

**2.1** This policy applies to:

**2.1.1** All undergraduate and postgraduate students at UPES

**2.1.2** **Only courses in which the student has already passed**

## 3. Definitions

| Term | Definition |
|---|---|
| **Grade Improvement** | A voluntary attempt to replace a previously earned passing grade with a higher grade |
| **Improvement Attempt** | A single permitted opportunity to improve a grade through an approved mode |

## 4. Core Principles

**4.1** **Grade improvement is a privilege, not an entitlement.**

**4.2** Grade improvement is **voluntary** and distinct from academic recovery.

**4.3** **Only one improvement attempt per course** is permitted.

**4.4** The **latest valid grade** shall be used for CGPA calculation, as per University rules.

## 5 Eligibility for Grade Improvement

**5.1** A student may apply for grade improvement only if:

**5.1.1** The student has **passed the course** (grade C or higher)

**5.1.2** The course is **eligible** for improvement as per University rules

**5.1.3** The student has **not already availed** a grade improvement attempt for that course

**5.1.4** The student is within the **UGC-prescribed maximum Programme duration (N+2+1)**

## 6. Modes of Grade Improvement

### 6.1 Supplementary Improvement Examination

**6.1.1** The student appears only for the End-Term component in Supplementary Examination

**6.1.2** Continuous Assessment marks are not re-earned

**6.1.3** Applicable only for courses and cycles notified by the University

**6.1.4** The improvement attempt shall be governed by all applicable rules, conditions, and limitations prescribed for Supplementary Examinations

### 6.2 Summer Semester

**6.2.1** The student enrols in the course during the **Summer Semester**

**6.2.2** All academic requirements (attendance, assessments, examinations) shall be completed afresh

**6.2.3** Grade improvement through Summer Semester shall be governed by the **Summer Semester Policy**

**6.2.4** Enrolment is subject to:

**6.2.4.1** Course offering

**6.2.4.2** Seat availability

**6.2.4.3** Prescribed fees

### 6.3 Course Repeat for Grade Improvement

**6.3.1** The student repeats the course through **regular semester enrolment**

**6.3.2** Governed operationally by the **Regular Course Repeat Policy**

### 6.4 Course Substitution for Grade Improvement

**6.4.1** Applicable only to **optional courses**

**6.4.2** Governed by the **Course Substitution Policy**

**6.4.3** Only **one substitution for grade improvement** is permitted during the entire Programme

**6.4.5** Course substitution for grade improvement shall not be permitted for core, mandatory, or prerequisite-bearing courses.

## 7. Limits & Attempt Applicability

**7.1** **Only one grade improvement attempt per course** shall be permitted, irrespective of mode.

**7.2** A grade improvement attempt shall be **counted within the maximum number of attempts permitted per course** under the Academic Progression Framework.

**7.3** Grade improvement **cannot be used to avoid**:

**7.3.1** Year Back provisions

**7.3.2** Progression controls

## 8. Credit Load & Timetabling

**8.1** A course taken for grade improvement:

**8.1.1** Counts towards the **maximum permissible credit load** for the semester

**8.2** The University does not guarantee resolution of timetable clashes. Any such clashes shall be the sole responsibility of the student.

**8.3** Approval is subject to course availability and operational feasibility

## 9. Grading & Transcript Treatment

**9.1** Upon successful completion:

**9.1.1** The **latest grade obtained** shall replace the earlier grade for CGPA calculation

**9.1.2** The improved grade shall appear on all subsequent transcripts

**9.2** All prior attempts shall remain part of the **internal academic record** for traceability

**9.3** Students who improve a course grade will **not be eligible for inclusion in the university merit list or for medal awards**

**9.4** The new grade earned will be recorded on the transcript, along with a remark indicating it was a grade improvement attempt

## 10. Fees

**10.1** A **non-waivable grade improvement fee** may be prescribed depending on the mode of improvement a student selects

**10.2** Fees, once paid, are **non-refundable**

**10.3** Fee applicability may vary by mode of grade improvement

## 11. Approval & Governance

**11.1** Grade improvement requests shall be subject to:

**11.1.1** Eligibility verification

**11.1.2** Attempt-limit validation

**11.1.3** Mode-specific approval as per linked policies

**11.2** Decisions shall be:

**11.2.1** Rule-based

**11.2.2** Documented

**11.2.3** Communicated formally to the student

## 12. Policy Governance & Revision

**12.1** This policy shall be reviewed periodically to ensure alignment with:

**12.1.1** UGC regulations

**12.1.2** NEP 2020 principles

**12.2** The University reserves the right to revise eligibility conditions, procedures, or applicable fees, with due notification and prospective application.

# COURSE AUDIT POLICY

**(Policy Code: AG-12)**

*This Policy shall come into force* ***with immediate effect***

## 1. Purpose

**1.1** The Course Audit Policy enables students at UPES to undertake additional courses **purely for learning enrichment**, without earning academic credit and without any impact on SGPA, CGPA, academic progression, or degree completion.

**1.2** Audit courses are intended to:

**1.2.1** Encourage interdisciplinary and exploratory learning

**1.2.2** Enable learning beyond Programme requirements

**1.2.3** Support personal, professional, and intellectual development

**1.2.4** Promote lifelong learning without academic or progression risk

**1.3** Audit courses are **non-credit, non-CGPA, voluntary**, and **do not contribute** to degree requirements.

## 2. Scope

**2.1** This policy applies to:

**2.1.1** All undergraduate and postgraduate students enrolled at UPES

**2.1.2** Courses explicitly approved for audit mode by the concerned School

**2.2** Audit courses are undertaken **without credit accumulation** and **without impact on academic progression**.

## 3. Definitions

| Term | Definition |
|---|---|
| **Audit Course** | A course taken for learning enrichment only, without academic credit and without CGPA impact |
| **Auditing a Course** | Registering for and attending a course in audit mode with the required approvals |
| **AP / AF Outcome** | Academic audit outcomes indicating Audit Pass (AP) or Audit Fail (AF), recorded as per University transcript rules |

## 4. Nature of Audit Courses

**4.1** Audit courses are:

**4.1.1** Strictly **non-credit**

**4.1.2** **Optional**

**4.1.3** Not counted toward graduation requirements

**4.1.4** Not included in SGPA or CGPA calculation

**4.1.5** Audited courses shall be evaluated solely based on participation and completion, in accordance with evaluation **parameters prescribed by the Course Instructor.**

**4.2** Audit courses **cannot** be converted into or used as:

**4.2.1** Credit-bearing courses

**4.2.2** Independent Study or Directed Reading

**4.2.3** Course Substitution

**4.2.4** Academic Recovery or Grade Improvement pathways

## 5. Eligibility

A student may audit a course only if:

**5.1** The course is approved for audit mode by the School

**5.2** Seat availability exists after completion of regular registrations

**5.3** Any prescribed prerequisites are met

**5.4** The student's regular academic commitments are not adversely affected

**5.5** Audit enrolment is a **privilege, not an entitlement**, and is subject to approval.

## 6. Permissible Courses for Audit

Audit may be permitted for:

**6.1** Elective courses

**6.2** Exploratory or interdisciplinary courses

**6.3** Skill-based or interest-driven offerings

**6.4** Mandatory or core courses

**6.5** Laboratories, studios, internships

## 7. Registration & Approval Authority

Audit registration is permitted **only after completion of regular course registration**.

**Approval Hierarchy**

| Authority | Role |
|---|---|
| **Course Instructor** | Recommends audit permission and defines participation expectations |
| **Programme Lead / Cluster Head** | Confirms academic feasibility and workload |
| **Dean of School** | Final approval authority |
| **Academic Planning & Operations (APO)** | Registration and record maintenance |
| **Controller of Examinations (CoE)** | Transcript notation |

## 8. Attendance & Participation

**8.1** A minimum of **75% attendance** is mandatory for successful completion of an audited course.

**8.2** **In addition to attendance**, the **Course Instructor may prescribe participation-based requirements**, which may include (but are not limited to):

- **8.2.1** Active class engagement
- **8.2.2** In-class activities
- **8.2.3** Short projects, papers, presentations, or learning reflections
- **8.2.4** Other non-graded academic tasks deemed appropriate by the Instructor for the nature of the course

**8.3** These requirements are **evaluative in nature only for audit completion** and **do not carry grades or affect CGPA**.

**8.4** Failure to fulfil the prescribed attendance and participation requirements shall result **in an *Audit Fail (AF)***, which **does not carry academic penalty or credit impact**.

**8.5** **All audit completion criteria must be pre-announced to students at the start of the course**

**8.6** The defined criteria shall be:

- **8.6.1** Documented by the Course Instructor, and
- **8.6.2** **S**ubmitted to the Academic Planning & Operations (APO) for record and audit purposes

**8.7** AP or AF outcomes shall be awarded **strictly based on the pre-declared criteria**

## 9. Assessment & Evaluation

**9.1** Audit courses are **not graded** for SGPA or CGPA

**9.2** No marks or academic credits are awarded

**9.3** Informal assessments may be used **only for learning feedback**

**9.4** Audit outcomes shall be recorded as:

- **9.4.1** **AP (Audit Pass)** – audit requirements satisfactorily met
- **9.4.2** **AF (Audit Fail)** – audit requirements not met

**9.5** AP and AF are **academic audit outcomes**, not grades, and carry **no credit or CGPA weightage**.

### 9.6 Transcript Recording for Audit Courses

- **9.6.1** AP and AF outcomes shall appear in the **Semester Transcript**
- **9.6.2** **In the Final Transcript and all consolidated transcripts issued thereafter, only audited courses with an AP (Audit Pass) outcome shall be reflected**
- **9.6.3** **Audit Fail (AF) outcomes shall not be displayed in the Final Transcript**

**9.7** Audited courses reflected in the Final Transcript shall:

**9.7.1** Appear without academic credit,

**9.7.2** Have no SGPA or CGPA impact, and

**9.7.3** Be clearly identified as **Audit Courses**

## 10. Fees

**10.1** Audit courses are ordinarily offered **without fee**

**10.2** The University reserves the right to prescribe a **nominal audit fee**, if required, with approval of the competent authority and prior notification

## 11. Restrictions & Safeguards

**11.1** Audit courses:

**11.1.1** Do not satisfy degree credit requirements

**11.1.2** Cannot be used to meet prerequisites

**11.1.3** Cannot replace failed or required courses

**11.1.4** Cannot be used for academic recovery, grade improvement, progression, ranking, honours, or merit determination

**11.2** Audit enrolment shall not dilute academic standards or disrupt regular teaching-learning processes.

## 12. Governance & Record Management

**12.1** Audit approvals and outcomes shall be:

**12.1.1** Rule-based

**12.1.2** Documented

**12.1.3** Uniformly applied across Schools

**12.2** All records shall be maintained by the **Academic Planning & Operations (APO)** and **Controller of Examinations (CoE)** for audit and transcript purposes.

## 13. Policy Review

**13.1** This policy shall be reviewed periodically to ensure alignment with:

**13.1.1** NEP 2020 principles

**13.1.2** Institutional academic strategy

**13.2** Any revisions shall be notified prospectively through official University communication.

# INTERNAL ACADEMIC MOBILITY

*(Change of Programme / Change of Major / Change of Specialisation)*

**(Policy Code: AG-13)**

*This Policy shall come into force* ***with immediate effect****.*

## 1. Purpose

**1.1** This Policy establishes a **comprehensive, regulated, and uniform framework** governing **internal academic mobility** at UPES, limited to:

- **1.1.1** Change of Programme
- **1.1.2** Change of Major
- **1.1.3** Change of Specialisation

**1.2** The Policy enables limited academic mobility while safeguarding:

- **1.2.1** Academic rigour and Programme learning outcomes
- **1.2.2** Prerequisite integrity and curriculum sequencing
- **1.2.3** Fairness, transparency, and auditability
- **1.2.4** Student protection against academic and regulatory risk

**1.3** This Policy operates strictly within **UGC-prescribed maximum Programme duration norms (N + 2 + 1)** and aligns with the **National Education Policy (NEP) 2020**, without diluting institutional standards.

## 2. Scope & Applicability

This Policy applies to:

**2.1** All full-time **Undergraduate and Postgraduate** students of UPES

**2.2** All Schools, Programmes, Majors, and Specialisations offered by the University

## 3. Core Principles

All internal academic mobility decisions shall be governed by the following principles:

**3.1** **Academic mobility is a privilege, not an entitlement**

**3.2** **No automatic right to credit transfer or credit carry-forward exists**

**3.3** **Academic feasibility shall override student preference**

**3.4** **Prerequisite and curriculum integrity shall not be compromised**

**3.5** **Seat availability and faculty capacity are mandatory conditions**

**3.6** **All changes must remain within the maximum Programme duration (N + 2 + 1)**

**3.7** **All approvals must be formally documented and ERP-recorded**

## 4. Definitions

| Term | Definition |
|---|---|
| **Academic Mobility** | A formally approved change within a student's enrolled academic structure, governed by this Policy. |
| **Change of Programme** | A change from one degree Programme to another, resulting in a change in the degree pursued. |
| **Change of Major** | A change in the primary disciplinary focus within the same degree Programme. |
| **Change of Specialisation** | A change within approved specialisation tracks of a major, without altering the degree or major. |
| **Credit Mapping** | An academic equivalence exercise to determine whether previously earned credits align with course learning outcomes in the revised academic structure. |
| **Academic Equivalence** | A determination by faculty that two courses are comparable in level, depth, content, and intended learning outcomes. |
| **Excess/Surplus Credits** | Credits earned by a student that are not mapped to graduation requirements under the revised academic structure. |

## 5. Common Eligibility Conditions

**5.1** Across all pathways covered under this Policy, a student must:

**5.1.1** Be formally enrolled at UPES

**5.1.2** Have no pending disciplinary proceedings

**5.1.3** Meet minimum academic standing requirements as prescribed by the School

**5.1.4** Satisfy academic feasibility, capacity, and regulatory constraints

**5.1.5** Meeting eligibility conditions **does not guarantee approval**.

### 5.2 Application Window

Applications for Change of Programme, Change of Major, or Change of Specialisation shall be accepted **only within the following timelines**:

#### 5.2.1 First Semester of the Programme

Applications must be submitted **no later than the commencement of mid-term examinations** of the first semester.

#### 5.2.2 After Completion of First Semester

Applications must be submitted **within the first week of the commencement of the relevant semester**.

Applications submitted after the first week of the semester shall **not be entertained**.

#### 5.2.3 Late or Out-of-Window Applications

No application shall be considered if the proposed change places the student at risk of **exceeding the maximum Programme duration (N + 2 + 1)**.

Requests submitted beyond the prescribed timelines shall be **summarily rejected**, without appeal on grounds of preference or hardship.

## 6. Credit Mapping & Academic Equivalence

**6.1** Credit mapping is an **academic equivalence exercise**, not an entitlement

**6.2** No automatic or blanket credit transfer shall be permitted

**6.3** Mapping decisions must be:

**6.3.1** Academically justified,

**6.3.1** Documented in the prescribed Credit Mapping & Equivalence Form (Annexure 2), and

**6.3.1** Auditable

**6.4** Unmapped credits may be classified as:

**6.4.1** Exploratory credits wherever feasible, or

**6.4.1** Excess/surplus credits not contributing to graduation

**6.5** Credit mapping shall not:

**6.5.1** Dilute Programme learning outcomes, or

**6.5.2** Bypass mandatory core courses or prerequisite chains

**6.6** All mapping decisions require School-level approval and ERP recording.

## 7. Limits & Restrictions

**7.1** Internal academic mobility under this Policy shall ordinarily be permitted **only once during a Programme**

**7.2** Late-stage requests may be restricted or denied due to curriculum feasibility

**7.3** No change shall be permitted if it results in:

**7.3.1** Extension beyond maximum Programme duration (N+2+1), or

**7.3.2** Compromise of academic standards or regulatory compliance

## 8. Governance & Approval Structure

| Authority | Responsibility |
|---|---|
| **Programme Lead / Cluster Head** | Academic feasibility and credit mapping review |
| **Dean of School** | Academic approval |
| **Registrar / Vice Provost** | Regulatory and duration compliance |
| **Academic Planning & Operations (APO)** | ERP implementation |

No academic change shall be valid unless reflected in the **ERP system**.

## 9. Appeals

**9.1** Appeals may be submitted **only on procedural grounds**

**9.2** Appeals shall not be entertained on grounds of preference, expectation, or academic judgement

**9.3** Appeal authority and timelines shall be notified separately

## 10. Change of Programme

### 10.1 Nature and Definition

Change of Programme refers to a **degree-level transition** wherein a student shifts from one approved degree Programme to another, resulting in a change in the qualification pursued (e.g., BBA to BTech, BA to BSc, MBA to MTech).

### 10.2 Eligibility Conditions

A student may be considered for Change of Programme only if:

**10.2.1** The student satisfies the minimum admission eligibility criteria of the target Programme, including subject background and applicable regulatory requirements

**10.2.2** The student applies within the permissible semester window notified by the University

**10.2.3** The student is in **acceptable academic standing**, as determined by the School

**10.2.4** Seat availability exists in the target Programme

Meeting the above eligibility conditions **does not guarantee approval**.

### 10.3 Programme Duration Reset

**10.3.1** Upon approval of Change of Programme, the student shall be treated as a **fresh entrant** to the new Programme for the purpose of **maximum Programme duration**.

**10.3.2** Accordingly, the **N + 2 + 1 time limit** shall apply independently to the new Programme, and time spent in the previous Programme shall not be counted toward this limit, subject to approved credit transfer and equivalence norms.

### 10.4 Credit Transfer and Semester Placement

**10.4.1** Notwithstanding Clause 10.3, credits earned by the student prior to the Change of Programme shall remain preserved in the **Academic Bank of Credits (ABC)**.

**10.4.2** The University may, subject to **approved academic equivalence, prerequisite compliance, regulatory requirements, and availability of vacancies**, permit transfer or mapping of eligible credits and place the student in an appropriate semester (including beyond Semester 1).

**10.4.3** Such semester placement shall **not alter the reset of the maximum Programme duration**, and the **N + 2 + 1 limit shall apply independently** to the new Programme, irrespective of credit transfer.

### 10.5 Credit Mapping and Academic Treatment

**10.5.1** There shall be **no automatic transfer of credits** between Programmes

**10.5.2** Credits shall be mapped only where **academic equivalence** is established

**10.5.3** Credits that cannot be mapped shall be classified as:

- Exploratory credits, or
- Excess / surplus credits not contributing to graduation

**10.5.4** The student shall acknowledge that **significant credit loss may occur** as a result of Change of Programme

**10.5.5** Credits earned prior to the Change of Programme shall remain preserved in the **Academic Bank of Credits (ABC)** for a maximum validity period of **seven (7) years**, and may be transferred or mapped only where academic equivalence, prerequisite compliance, and regulatory requirements are fulfilled, in accordance with University and UGC norms

**10.5.6** In accordance with UGC regulations, **only credits earned in Academic Year 2021–22 and thereafter** shall be eligible for credit accumulation, transfer, and redemption through the Academic Bank of Credits (ABC)

### 10.6 Timing and Stage Restrictions

**10.6.1** Change of Programme shall ordinarily be permitted only in **early semesters**, as notified by the University

**10.6.2** Requests at advanced stages may be rejected due to:

- Curriculum sequencing constraints

- Prerequisite misalignment
- Graduation feasibility risk

**10.7 Additional Safeguards**

**10.7.1** For undergraduate Programmes, a **Parent / Guardian Undertaking** shall be mandatory

**10.7.2** A revised academic plan and graduation timeline shall apply

**10.7.3** The student shall be governed by the **prevailing curriculum** of the target Programme

## 11. Change of Major

### 11.1 Nature and Definition

Change of Major refers to a **disciplinary shift within the same degree Programme**, wherein a student changes the primary field of study while continuing within the same degree framework (e.g., BTech Mechanical to BTech Computer Science, BBA Marketing to BBA Finance).

Change of Major does **not** alter the degree awarded but significantly impacts **curriculum depth, prerequisites, and sequencing**.

### 11.2 Eligibility Conditions

A student may be considered for Change of Major only if:

**11.2.1** The change occurs within the **same degree Programme**

**11.2.2** The student satisfies **academic preparedness requirements** for the target major

**11.2.3** All **prerequisite conditions** prescribed by the target major can be met

**11.2.4** Seat availability exists in the target major

**11.2.5** The change does not compromise graduation within maximum duration (N+2+1)

### 11.3 Credit Mapping and Curriculum Alignment

**11.3.1** Credits already earned shall be mapped **only where academic equivalence exists**

**11.3.2** Core courses of the new major that were not previously undertaken **must be completed**

**11.3.3** Credit mapping shall not:

**11.3.3.1** Bypass prerequisite chains, or

**11.3.3.2** Dilute discipline depth

Unmapped credits may be retained as exploratory or excess/surplus credits.

### 11.4 Timing and Limits

**11.4.1** Change of Major shall ordinarily be permitted **only once during the Programme**

**11.4.2** Requests made after substantial completion of major-specific coursework may be denied

### 11.5 Academic Progression Post-Change

**11.5.1** The student shall follow the **approved academic structure** of the new major

**11.5.2** Prerequisite enforcement shall apply strictly

**11.5.3** Graduation timelines may be revised based on feasibility

## 12. Change of Specialisation

### 12.1 Nature

Change of Specialisation refers to a change between approved specialisation tracks **within the same major and degree**, without altering the Programme or major.

### 12.2 Eligibility & Conditions

Change of Specialisation may be permitted subject to:

**12.2.1** Availability of the target specialisation,

**12.2.2** Compliance with prescribed prerequisites, and

**12.2.3** Academic feasibility within the approved Programme duration.

### 12.3 Credit Treatment

**12.3.1** Common core and major credits shall be retained.

**12.3.2** Specialisation-specific credits shall be mapped only where academically equivalent.

**12.3.3** Unmapped credits, if any, shall not contribute to specialisation completion.

### 12.4 Progression & Completion

The student shall be governed by the **requirements of the target specialisation**, and all prescribed specialisation credits must be completed for transcript recognition.

# POLICY ON CHANGE OF MINOR

**(Policy Code: AG-14)**

*Applicable from* ***Admission Year 2026***

## 1. Purpose

**1.1** This Policy defines the institutional framework, eligibility conditions, and governing principles for **Change of Minor** for undergraduate students at UPES.

**1.2** The Policy aims to:

**1.2.1** Enable structured academic flexibility and informed student choice in alignment with **NEP 2020**

**1.2.2** Ensure academic coherence, prerequisite integrity, and credit feasibility across Programmes

**1.2.3** Prevent misuse, dilution, or partial recognition of Minor credentials

**1.2.4** Maintain consistency, transparency, and audit readiness across all Schools

**1.3** **Change of Minor is a regulated academic flexibility and not an entitlement.**

## 2. Scope

**2.1** This Policy applies to:

**2.1.1** All full-time undergraduate students enrolled in **three-year and four-year degree Programmes** at UPES

**2.1.2** All **formally approved Minor Programmes** offered by UPES Schools

## 3. Definitions

| Term | Definition |
|---|---|
| **Minor** | A structured and approved set of courses (typically **24 credits**) pursued outside the student's Major discipline, which is reflected on the **final transcript and degree certificate only upon full completion**. |
| **Change of Minor** | The formal academic process through which a student discontinues an approved Minor and opts for a different Minor, subject to **eligibility conditions, prescribed timelines, academic feasibility, and institutional approval**. |
| **Exploratory Credits** | University-approved courses that allow students to explore disciplines outside their declared Major or Minor **without commitment to a credential**. |
| **Excess/Surplus Credits (Non-Contributory)** | Credits earned by a student that are retained on the academic record but **do not contribute toward Major, Minor, or graduation credit requirements**. |

## 4. Guiding Principles

**4.1** Change of Minor at UPES is governed by the following principles:

**4.1.1** **Flexibility with accountability** – Minor changes are permitted early in the academic journey, but not indefinitely

**4.1.2 No academic dilution** – A Minor is awarded only upon full and complete fulfilment of prescribed requirements

**4.1.3 No retroactive entitlement** – Credits already earned do not guarantee automatic mapping to a new Minor

**4.1.4 Prerequisite integrity** – Foundational sequencing and learning progression must be preserved

**4.1.5 Time-bound decision-making** – Late-stage changes are restricted to safeguard academic coherence

**4.1.6 Capacity-linked approval** – Approval is subject to seat availability, faculty capacity, timetable feasibility, and academic resources

**4.2** The University does not guarantee approval of Change of Minor solely on the basis of student eligibility.

## 5. Eligibility Conditions

**5.1** A student may apply for Change of Minor **only if all** the following conditions are met:

| Condition | Requirement |
|---|---|
| **Application Window** | Application submitted no later than the **end of Semester 3** |
| **Credit Feasibility** | Completion of the proposed Minor is feasible within the **maximum permissible Programme duration** |
| **Prerequisites** | Entry prerequisites for the proposed Minor are fully satisfied |
| **Load Compliance** | Per-semester and total Programme credit limits are not breached |
| **Seat Availability** | Seats are available in the proposed Minor, as determined by the offering School |

**5.2** The prescribed application window ensures sufficient remaining semesters to complete the Minor without compromising Programme duration norms.

## 6. Permissible Scenarios

### 6.1 Early-Stage Change (Preferred)

Where the student has completed **Exploratory credits or not more than 6 credits** of the originally declared Minor:

Completed courses may be:

**6.1.1** Reclassified as **Exploratory credits**, or

**6.1.2** Mapped to the new Minor **only if explicitly approved**

**6.1.3 Treated as excess / surplus, non-contributory credits** where such courses are not mapped to any academic category.

**6.1.4** No assurance of credit carry-forward is provided

### 6.2 Mid-Stage Change (Restricted)

Where the student has completed **more than 6 but fewer than 12 credits** of the originally declared Minor:

Change of Minor may be permitted **only if**:

**6.2.1** Academic feasibility is clearly demonstrated, and

**6.2.2** The student acknowledges that completion of the new Minor **may require enrolment in Summer Semester and/or Directed Reading (DR)** to remain within the **maximum permissible Programme duration (N+2+1)**

No extension beyond the maximum permissible Programme duration shall be granted on account of Change of Minor.

### 6.3 Late-Stage Change (Not Permitted)

Where the student has completed **12 or more credits** of a declared Minor:

**6.3.1** Change of Minor **shall not be permitted**

**6.3.2** The student must either:

**6.3.2.1** Complete the declared Minor, or

**6.3.2.2** Continue remaining courses, if any, as **Exploratory credits if feasible** (no Minor credential)

## 7. Credit Treatment Rules

| Situation | Credit Treatment |
|---|---|
| **Courses common to both Minors** | May be mapped to the new Minor, subject to academic equivalence review and formal approval. |
| **Non-overlapping courses** | Shall be reclassified as **excess / surplus credits** or **Exploratory credits**, as determined by the academic approving authority. |
| **Partial completion of a Minor** | No Minor credential shall be awarded unless all prescribed Minor requirements are fully completed. |
| **Surplus credits** | Shall not reduce Major, Minor, or overall graduation credit requirements. |
| **Transcript treatment of surplus credits** | Surplus credits shall remain visible on the academic record but shall not contribute toward degree or credential fulfilment. |

## 8. Impact on Degree & Transcript

**8.1** Only **fully completed Minors** shall appear on the final transcript and degree certificate

**8.2** Discontinued or partially completed Minors shall **not** be mentioned

**8.3** Exploratory and surplus credits shall continue to appear in **semester-wise transcripts**

## 9. Approval & Process Overview

**9.1** All Change of Minor requests shall undergo a structured academic review, including:

**9.1.1** Verification of eligibility conditions

**9.1.2** Academic feasibility assessment and credit mapping

**9.1.3** Confirmation of seat availability by the offering School

**9.1.4** Determination of whether **Summer Semester and/or Directed Reading (DR)** is required for timely completion

**9.2** Final approval shall rest with the **designated academic authority**, as notified by the University.

**9.3** Detailed operational steps, documentation requirements, and timelines shall be governed through a **separate Standard Operating Procedure (Annexure 1)**.

## 10. Limitations & Restrictions

**10.1** A student may change Minor **only once** during the entire Programme

**10.2** Change of Minor **cannot be combined** with:

**10.2.1** Change of Programme or Change of Major, or

**10.2.2** Special credit overloads, relaxations, or exemptions

**10.3** Where multiple academic change requests exist, **Change of Programme or Major shall take precedence**

**10.4** **Summer Semester and Directed Reading (DR), if prescribed for Minor completion, shall attract applicable fees**, as notified by the University

**10.5** No fee waivers or exceptions shall apply unless expressly approved by the competent authority

## 11. Interaction with Other Academic Changes

**11.1** Change of Major may require reassessment or discontinuation of an approved Minor

**11.2** Change of Programme shall automatically supersede any approved Minor unless explicitly retained by the University

## 12. Exceptional Cases

**12.1** In rare and well-justified circumstances—such as Minor discontinuation, Programme restructuring, or regulatory change—the University may permit deviation from this Policy subject to approval by the competent authority.

**12.2** Such approvals shall be:

**12.2.1 Exception**-based, and

**12.2.2 Non-precedent setting**

## 13. Policy Governance, Review & Effective Date

**13.1 Right to Revise Minor Structure:** The University and the concerned School reserve the right to **revise, modify, restructure, suspend, or withdraw Minor offerings**, including credit structure and course composition, in accordance with academic requirements, regulatory directions, and institutional priorities.

**13.2 Effective Date:** This Policy shall be **effective from Academic Year 2026–27** and shall apply to all students seeking Change of Minor from this academic year onwards.

**13.3 Periodic Review:** This Policy shall be reviewed periodically to ensure continued alignment with:

**13.3.1** NEP 2020

**13.3.2** Institutional academic strategy

**13.4** Change of Minor is a **regulated academic provision and not an entitlement**. All determinations relating to eligibility, credit treatment, academic feasibility, equivalence, and approval shall be **final and binding**, as decided by the competent academic authorities of the University.

# LATERAL ENTRY & INTER-INSTITUTIONAL MIGRATION ADMISSIONS POLICY

**(Policy Code: AG-15)**

*This Policy shall come into force* ***with immediate effect****.*

## 1. Purpose

**1.1** This Policy establishes a transparent, student-centric, and regulator-compliant framework governing:

**1.2** This Policy defines a **regulator-compliant and academically robust framework** governing:

**1.2.1** **Multiple entry options**, and

**1.2.2** **Lateral entry**

**1.3** Into **Undergraduate (UG) and Postgraduate (PG) Programmes** of the University, in alignment with:

**1.3.1** National Education Policy (NEP) 2020

**1.3.2** UGC Guidelines on Multiple Entry and Exit in Academic Programmes (July 2021)

**1.3.3** Academic Bank of Credits (ABC) Regulations

**1.4** The Policy ensures:

**1.4.1** Parity with regular entrants,

**1.4.2** Structured recognition of prior learning, and

**1.4.3** Seamless academic mobility without compromise on academic standards.

## 2. Scope & Applicability

**2.1** This Policy applies to:

**2.1.1** All **Undergraduate and Postgraduate Programmes** offered by the University.

**2.1.2** Admissions through:

**2.1.2.1** Regular Entry, and

**2.1.2.2 Lateral Entry at approved academic levels only**.

**2.2** Where lateral entry is **not permitted** due to statutory or academic constraints, the same shall be **explicitly notified** in the Admission Prospectus and University website for the relevant admission cycle.

## 3. Definitions

### 3.1

| Term | Definition |
|---|---|
| **Entry Options** | Recognised academic entry points into an ongoing degree Programme, based on earned credits and qualifications, as permitted under UGC norms. |
| **Lateral Entry** | Admission into a Programme beyond the first year / first semester, based on recognised prior credits, established academic equivalence, and availability of approved vacancies. |
| **Academic Bank of Credits (ABC)** | A national digital repository that enables accumulation, transfer, and redemption of academic credits to support multiple entry pathways under applicable regulations. |
| **Lateral Entry (Undergraduate – UPES)** | Admission into an ongoing undergraduate Programme at UPES, normally into Semester 3, based on prior learning completed at a recognised institution (such as a diploma or equivalent qualification), in accordance with applicable regulatory norms. |
| **Inter-Institutional Migration (Migration)** | Transfer of a currently enrolled undergraduate student from another recognised university into the same or an academically equivalent Programme at UPES, typically after completion of Semester 1 or Semester 2, subject to availability of vacancies, regulatory permissions, and academic equivalence approval. |
| **Credit Equivalence** | A structured academic evaluation involving course-wise mapping of Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs), content coverage, assessment rigour, credits, and contact hours to determine parity with the UPES curriculum. |
| **Bridge Course** | A structured academic intervention prescribed to address credit, content, or prerequisite gaps, delivered through Junior Batch enrolment, Directed Reading (DR), and/or Summer Semester or Special Term. |
| **Credit Transfer & Equivalence Committee (CTEC)*** | A statutory University committee responsible for reviewing, approving, and recording all credit equivalence, credit transfer, and bridge course decisions under this Policy. |
| **Vacancy** | A seat that remains unfilled after completion of the regular admission process for the relevant academic year and Programme, as approved by the competent authority. |

**3.2 Credit Transfer & Equivalence Committee (CTEC) Composition:**

**3.2.1 Chair:** Vice Provost

**3.2.2 Members:**

**3.2.2.1** School Nominee (Programme Expert)

**3.2.2.2** Controller of Examinations

**3.2.2.3** Academic Planning & Operations (APO) Representative

**3.2.2.4** Student Records Representative

**3.2.3** Quorum: Minimum three (3) members

**3.3** Where a School Expert involved in course evaluation is also a CTEC member, the individual shall recuse themselves from the final decision, and the Chair may nominate an alternate expert to avoid conflict of interest.

## 4. Applicability by Admission Route

**4.1**

| Parameter | Lateral Entry | Migration |
|---|---|---|
| Entry Semester | Odd Semester | Semester 2 onwards |
| Prior Academic Status | Diploma / Degree holder | Enrolled UG student |
| Regulatory Basis | AICTE / PCI / BCI norms | UGC Migration norms |
| Intake Limit | ≤10% of sanctioned intake | Vacancy-based only |
| Credit Mapping | Mandatory | Mandatory |
| Bridge Courses | Permitted | Permitted |

**4.2 Permissible UG Entry Levels**

| Entry Point | Academic Requirement | Entry Allowed In |
|---|---|---|
| Entry at Year 1 | Grade 12 / equivalent qualification | Semester 1 |
| Entry at Year 2 | Undergraduate Certificate (36–40 credits or more, Level 5) | Semester 3 |
| Entry at Year 3 | Undergraduate Diploma (72–80 credits or more, Level 6) | Semester 5 |

**4.2 Permissible PG Entry Levels**

| PG Programme Type | Entry Qualification | Entry Allowed In |
|---|---|---|
| One-year Master's Programme | Four-year Undergraduate's Degree (Honours / Research) | Semester 1 |
| Two-year Master's Programme | Undergraduate's Degree (3-year or 4-year) | Semester 1 |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Integrated Bachelor–Master Programme | Grade 12 qualification | Semester 1 |

## 5. Eligibility

### 5.1 General Conditions

Admission under this Policy shall be permitted only if:

**5.1.1** Entry is sought into approved semesters as notified by the University

**5.1.2** The applicant has no unresolved academic backlogs or failures at the source institution at the time of final admission confirmation

**5.1.3** The applicant meets the minimum eligibility criteria prescribed for the Programme

**5.1.4** The applicant satisfies regulatory requirements applicable to the discipline

**5.1.5** The School may conduct written tests and/or interviews as part of academic screening

**5.2** A relaxation of up to 10% in eligibility may be granted to outstanding sportspersons, subject to:

**5.2.1** Applicable UGC / Sports Authority of India guidelines, and

**5.2.2** Approval of the Admissions Supervision Committee.

### 5.3 Programme-Specific Eligibility

Programme-wise eligibility conditions shall be specified in Annexure 1 and notified for each admission cycle.

## 6. Intake, Vacancies & Reservation

**6.1** Lateral Entry admissions shall not exceed 10% of the sanctioned intake or the regulator-prescribed cap, whichever is lower

**6.2** Migration admissions shall be permitted strictly against existing vacancies

**6.3** No supernumerary seats shall be created unless explicitly permitted by the regulator

**6.4** PCI norms (Pharmacy) and BCI Rules (Law) shall apply wherever relevant

**6.5** Statutory reservation norms shall apply as per UPES policy

Change of Programme, Major, or Specialisation after admission under this Policy shall be governed only by the UPES Internal Academic Mobility Policy and within prescribed application windows.

## 7. University Discretion

**7.1** Admission through Lateral Entry or Inter-Institutional Migration is not an entitlement.
**7.2** Meeting minimum eligibility criteria does not guarantee admission.

**7.3** The University reserves the right to approve or reject applications based on:

**7.3.1** Academic equivalence outcomes,

**7.3.2** Capacity constraints,

**7.3.3** Regulatory requirements, and

**7.3.4** Institutional academic priorities.

## 8. Credit Transfer & Equivalence Framework

**8.1** Applicants shall submit:

**8.1.1** Academic Bank of Credits (ABC) ID and/or official transcripts

**[Note:** Credits earned by a student **prior to admission through Lateral Entry or Inter-Institutional Migration** shall remain preserved in the **Academic Bank of Credits (ABC)** for a **maximum validity period of seven (7) years**, as per applicable UGC norms.

Such credits may be considered for **transfer, accumulation, or mapping** to the new Programme **only where academic equivalence, prerequisite compliance, and applicable regulatory requirements are fully satisfied**, and subject to approval by the competent academic authority of the University. Further, in accordance with **UGC regulations**, **only credits earned in Academic Year 2021–22 and thereafter** shall be eligible for **credit accumulation, transfer, and redemption through the Academic Bank of Credits (ABC)**.

**8.1.2** Detailed syllabus including credits, contact hours, CLOs, and assessment schemes

### 8.2 Evaluation Parameters

Credit equivalence shall be evaluated based on:

**8.2.1** CLO alignment

**8.2.2** Content overlap

**8.2.3** Assessment rigour

**8.2.4** Credit and contact hour matching

Evaluation shall be conducted using a documented academic rubric approved by CTEC.

### 8.3 Equivalence Thresholds

**8.3.1** ≥70% similarity: Equivalent — credit transferred

**8.3.2** 50–69% similarity: Conditional equivalence with mandatory bridge courses

**8.3.3** <50% similarity: Not equivalent

All partial or conditional equivalence decisions shall be explicitly justified and recorded in CTEC minutes.

### 8.4 Credit Handling Rules

**8.4.1** Where UPES credit value is higher, the deficit shall be addressed through bridge courses/modules

**8.4.2** Where external credit value is higher, UPES credit value shall prevail

**8.4.3** All recognised credits shall be posted to the Academic Bank of Credits (ABC) using University-approved templates

## 9. Prerequisite Enforcement

UPES follows a strict prerequisite-based academic progression model.

**9.1** Prerequisite alignment shall be verified for all mapped courses and future registrations

**9.2** Prerequisites shall not be waived under any circumstances

**9.3** All gaps shall be recorded and addressed through an approved Bridge Plan

**9.4** Students shall not be permitted to register for a course unless prerequisites are fulfilled

## 10. Bridge Courses

**10.1** Bridge courses prescribed under this Policy shall be:

**10.1.1** Designed and delivered by the respective School, and

**10.1.1** Academically equivalent to regular courses.

**10.2** Permitted Modes

**10.2.1** Regular Course Repeat

**10.2.2** Directed Reading (DR)

**10.2.3** Summer Semester

**10.2.4** MOOCs

**10.3** A maximum of two (2) bridge courses per term may be prescribed.

**10.4** Any exception beyond this limit shall require approval of the Pro Vice Chancellor.

**10.5 Fee Applicability for Bridge Courses**

Bridge courses shall be governed by the following fee rules:

**10.5.1** Bridge courses undertaken during a regular semester, as part of approved semester registration, shall be governed by the applicable regular semester fee structure and shall not attract any additional or separate bridge course fee.

**10.5.2** Bridge courses undertaken through Summer Semester or Directed Reading (DR) shall attract applicable fees, as notified by the University from time to time.

**10.5.3** Fee liability for Summer Semester and Directed Reading bridge courses is mandatory and non-waivable, irrespective of the mode of admission.

No exemption, waiver, or adjustment of fees shall be permitted solely on the basis of admission through Lateral Entry or Inter-Institutional Migration.

**10.6 Academic Rules for Bridge Courses**

Bridge courses shall:

**10.6.1** Carry regular academic credits,

**10.6.2** Follow standard attendance, assessment, and grading rules, and

**10.6.3** Be governed by UPES academic regulations.

All bridge courses must be completed by the end of the pre-final year.

**10.7 Failure & Academic Progression**

Failure to complete prescribed bridge courses or prerequisite requirements within approved timelines shall result in the student being governed by applicable UPES Academic Recovery Pathways, registration restrictions, and continuation rules.

No special exemption shall be granted solely due to the mode of admission.

## 11. Attendance, Assessment & Academic Regulations

All attendance, assessment, grading, condonement, and debarment rules shall be governed by:

**11.1** UPES Attendance Policy

**11.2** UPES Attendance Condonement Policy

**11.3** UPES Assessment & Evaluation Policy

No relaxation shall be permitted solely due to Lateral Entry or Migration status.

## 12. Maximum Duration of Study

All students admitted under this Policy must complete their Programme within the UGC-prescribed maximum duration (N + 2 + 1 years), inclusive of:

**12.1** Bridge courses,

**12.1** Summer enrolments, and

**12.1** Any migration-related delays.

## 13. Student & Parent / Guardian Undertaking

At the time of offer acceptance, students and parents/guardians (where applicable) shall submit a signed undertaking acknowledging:

**13.1** Mandatory completion of bridge and prerequisite courses,

**13.2** Possible increased academic load or timetable overlaps,

**13.3** Potential delay in graduation, additional fees and

**13.4** Applicability of all UPES academic regulations.

## 14. Grievance & Appeals

**14.1** Appeals may be submitted within seven (7) working days of decision notification

**14.2** One-time clarification or additional evidence may be submitted within the appeal window

**14.3** Appeals shall be adjudicated by the Pro Vice Chancellor

**14.4** Decisions shall be final and binding

## 15. Workflow, Governance & Records

**15.1** All workflows, approval matrices, and record-keeping requirements shall be governed by SoPs in Annexures.

**15.2** All decisions shall be documented and subject to internal and external audit.

## 16. Review & Revision

This Policy shall be reviewed every two (2) years, or earlier if required, to ensure alignment with: UGC regulations / ICTE / PCI / BCI norms

# ACADEMIC APPEALS & RE-EVALUATION POLICY

## (Policy Code: AG-16)

*This Policy shall come into force* ***with immediate effect.***

## 1. PURPOSE

**1.1** The UPES Academic Appeals & Re-evaluation Policy establishes a structured, transparent, confidential, and time-bound framework for the resolution of academic appeals and examination re-evaluation requests.

**1.2** This Policy is intended to:

**1.2.1** Uphold principles of natural justice, procedural fairness, and consistency

**1.2.2** Clearly distinguish examination re-evaluation processes from non-examination academic appeals, and define appropriate authority and finality for each

**1.2.3** Prevent ad-hoc, discretionary, or parallel appeal mechanisms

**1.2.4** Protect academic standards while ensuring fairness to students

## 2. SCOPE & APPLICABILITY

This Policy applies to all undergraduate and postgraduate students of UPES.

It governs:

**2.1** Appeals related to **non-examination academic decisions**

**2.2** Requests and appeals related to **End-Term examination re-evaluation**

**2.3** Appeals arising from **academic mobility decisions**, including Change of Programme, Change of Major, Change of Specialisation, and Change of Minor

## 3. TERMINOLOGY CLARIFICATION

**3.1** For the purposes of this Policy:

**3.1.1** **Academic Appeal** refers to a challenge raised against a non-examination academic decision, limited strictly to procedural error, administrative error, or incorrect application of published academic rules.

**3.1.2** **Re-evaluation** refers exclusively to the review of End-Term examination answer scripts, conducted under the authority of the Controller of Examinations.

**3.2** No academic appeal shall be treated as a re-evaluation request, and no re-evaluation request shall be treated as an academic appeal.

## 4. MATTERS NOT COVERED UNDER THIS POLICY

The following matters are expressly excluded and shall not be appealable under this Policy:

**4.1** Academic judgment regarding the quality of answers, merit of performance, or grading discretion

**4.2** Course design, syllabus content, curriculum structure, assessment weightages, or pedagogy approved by statutory bodies

**4.3 Attendance condonation decisions or policy-based attendance determinations**

**4.4** Consequences of non-submission, absence, or failure to meet notified requirements

**4.5** Issues arising from missed deadlines where timelines were duly notified

**4.6** Disciplinary matters, including academic misconduct or unfair means, governed under the UPES Academic Integrity & Student Academic Misconduct Policy

## 5. EXAMINATION RE-EVALUATION & POST RE-EVALUATION GRIEVANCE

The examination re-evaluation and post re-evaluation grievance process is governed by examination-specific mechanisms prescribed under University regulations and operates independently of the School-level academic appeal process outlined in this Policy.

1.1 **Eligibility for Re-evaluation**

**5.1.1** A student may apply for re-evaluation of an End-Term examination answer script after declaration of results, in accordance with University rules.

**5.1.2** Re-evaluation is available **only for End-Term examinations** and only through the process defined in this Policy.

**5.2 Authority**

**5.2.1** All matters relating to examination re-evaluation and post re-evaluation grievance redressal are governed by the **Controller of Examinations (CoE)**.

**5.2.2** Schools, faculty members, Programme Leads, and Deans **do not handle** examination re-evaluation or post re-evaluation grievances.

**5.3 Mode of Application**

**5.3.1** Applications for re-evaluation shall be submitted **only through the University ERP system**, within the timeline notified after result declaration.

**5.3.2** Applications submitted through email, physical representation, or informal communication shall not be accepted.

**5.3.3** The prescribed re-evaluation fee shall be paid online at the time of application.

**5.4 Re-evaluation Process**

1.a.1 Upon receipt of a valid re-evaluation application, the Controller of Examinations shall arrange for re-evaluation of the answer script in accordance with approved University procedures.

1.a.2 Re-evaluation is conducted independently of the original evaluation.

1.a.3 After completion of re-evaluation, the revised result, if any, shall be processed by the CoE.

1.a.4 The student shall be informed **only of the revised grade or result**, and not the numerical marks or detailed evaluation.

### 5.5 Outcome of Re-evaluation

**5.5.1** The outcome of re-evaluation may result in **no change, increase, or decrease** in the grade.

**5.5.2** The result declared after re-evaluation shall replace the earlier result for all academic purposes.

1.1.3 If the student is satisfied with the outcome, the matter stands closed.

### 1.2 Grievance After Re-evaluation

**5.6.1** If a student remains dissatisfied after completion of the re-evaluation, the student may submit a **grievance related to the re-evaluation outcome**.

1.a.2 This grievance does **not** constitute a second re-evaluation and does **not** involve fresh assessment of the answer script.

### 5.7 Grievance Redressal by University-Level Committee

**5.7.1** A grievance raised after re-evaluation shall be placed before a **University-level grievance redressal committee** constituted for examination matters, as prescribed under University examination regulations.

**5.7.2** The role of the committee is limited to examining the grievance related to the re-evaluation outcome in accordance with University examination procedures.

**5.7.3** The committee shall **not** conduct any fresh evaluation, re-evaluation, or reassessment of the answer script.

**5.7.4** The committee's examination shall focus on whether the re-evaluation process was duly carried out as prescribed.

### 5.8 Decision and Finality

**5.8.1** The decision taken after grievance redressal by the University-level committee shall be **final and binding**.

**5.8.2** The student shall be informed of the final outcome as per University procedure.

**5.8.3** **No further appeal, representation, or petition** shall be entertained after this stage in relation to the same examination.

### 5.9 Important Clarifications for Students

**5.9.1** Examination re-evaluation and post re-evaluation grievance processes are **separate from School-level academic appeals**.

**5.9.2** Faculty members, Programme Leads, Deans, and Schools **cannot intervene** in examination re-evaluation or grievance decisions.

**5.9.3** Requests for disclosure of answer scripts, evaluator identity, or detailed marking are **not permitted**.

## 6. ACADEMIC APPEALS (NON-EXAMINATION)

Academic appeals under this Policy relate to **non-examination academic decisions** and are limited strictly to **procedural errors, administrative or clerical errors, data or record-related errors, or incorrect application of published academic rules**.

Academic appeals **shall not** involve re-evaluation of academic merit, quality of answers, grading discretion, or policy relaxation.

The categories of academic appeals covered under this section are detailed below.

**6.1 Continuous Assessment (CA) Appeals**

**6.1.1** Continuous Assessment constitutes **70% of course evaluation (Internal Assessment + Mid-Course Evaluation)**,

**6.1.2** Appeals shall not be entertained on academic judgment, marks awarded, grading stringency, or comparative performance.

**Permissible CA appeals are limited to:**

**6.1.3** Incorrect tabulation or upload of CA marks

**6.1.4** Non-adherence to notified rubrics or approved assessment schemes

**6.1.5** Demonstrable procedural irregularity or bias

**6.1.6** Verified LMS or system-related errors

**6.2 Attendance-Related Appeals (Data & Computation Only)**

Attendance-related appeals may be raised **only for data correction or computation errors**.

**Permissible attendance appeals include:**

**6.2.1** Errors in attendance data entry

**6.2.2** Errors in attendance percentage computation

**6.2.3** Verified ERP or system-related discrepancies affecting attendance records

**The following shall not be appealable:**

**6.2.4** Attendance condonation requests

**6.2.5** Policy-based attendance relaxations

**6.2.6** Appeals based on illness, personal circumstances, academic performance, or lack of awareness

**6.3 Prerequisite Enforcement Appeals**

Appeals relating to prerequisite enforcement may be considered **only on procedural or system-related grounds**.

**Permissible prerequisite appeals include:**

**6.3.1** Incorrect prerequisite mapping

**6.3.2** ERP or system error resulting in incorrect prerequisite blocking

**The following shall not be appealable:**

**6.3.3** Waiver of prerequisites due to poor academic performance or failure

**6.3.4** Graduation pressure, placement timelines, or personal inconvenience

**6.3.5** Appeals violating UGC / AICTE / University regulations

**6.4 Registration & Academic Progression Appeals**

Appeals relating to registration or academic progression may be considered **only where an error in application of rules or records is established**.

**Permissible appeals include:**

**6.4.1** Registration block due to data or system error

**6.4.2** Incorrect application of progression or eligibility rules

**The following shall not be appealable:**

**6.4.3** Requests for relaxation of minimum credit or progression requirements

**6.4.4** Appeals seeking exceptions to maximum Programme duration norms

**6.5 Credit Mapping, Equivalence & Transfer Appeals**

Appeals relating to credits may be considered **only on record or mapping errors**.

**Permissible credit appeals include:**

**6.5.1** Credit equivalence applied incorrectly

**6.5.2** Approved credits not reflected in the academic record

**The following shall not be appealable:**

**6.5.3** Discretionary credit approval requests

**6.5.4** Appeals challenging statutory or curriculum-approved credit frameworks

**6.6 Academic Mobility Appeals**

Academic mobility appeals include decisions relating to:

**6.6.1** Change of Programme

**6.6.2** Change of Major

**6.6.3** Change of Specialisation

**6.6.4** Change of Minor

Such appeals shall be considered **only on procedural grounds**.

**Permissible academic mobility appeals include:**

**6.6.5** Error in processing the application

**6.6.6** Data or record-related error

**6.6.7** Incorrect application of published eligibility conditions

**The following shall not be appealable:**

**6.6.8** Academic judgment regarding suitability or feasibility

**6.6.9** Capacity constraints or cut-offs

**6.6.10** Missed timelines duly notified

**6.6.11** Discretionary decisions taken in accordance with approved policy

Academic mobility appeals shall be submitted **in writing to the Pro-Vice Chancellor / Vice Provost** for consideration.

### 6.7 Incorrect Application of Published Academic Rules

Appeals may be raised where a student is adversely affected due to **incorrect interpretation or application of a published academic policy, regulation, or rule**.

Such appeals shall:

**6.7.1** Be examined strictly on documentary evidence

**6.7.2** Not result in creation of new academic entitlements or policy relaxations

### 6.8 General Conditions Applicable to All Academic Appeals

**6.8.1** Appeals must be submitted within the **officially notified timelines**, where applicable.

**6.8.2** Appeals shall not entitle students to **provisional or conditional registration** pending final decision.

**6.8.3** Submission of false, misleading, or fabricated information shall result in summary rejection and may attract disciplinary action.

## 7. SCHOOL-LEVEL ACADEMIC APPEAL PROCESS

All non-examination academic appeals shall follow the mandatory sequential escalation below.

| Appeal Level | Authority | When Applicable | Role & Responsibilities | Outcome / Status |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Level 1** | **Concerned Faculty Member** | Initial stage of all non-examination academic appeals | • Student approaches the concerned faculty member directly• Attempts resolution of the academic issue at the instructional level | Matter resolved **or** escalated to next level |
| **Level 2** | **Programme Lead** | If the issue remains unresolved at the Faculty level | • Reviews procedural compliance• Examines relevant academic records and documentation• Issues a reasoned response | Matter resolved **or** escalated to next level |
| **Level 3 (Final)** | **Dean of the School** | If the issue remains unresolved at the Programme Lead level | • Reviews **procedural correctness only**• Bases decision strictly on documented evidence• Issues a reasoned and written decision | **Final and binding decision**No further appeal permitted |

## 8. MODE OF SUBMISSION & RECORD MANAGEMENT

**8.1** Academic appeals under Section 6 shall be submitted to School Office using (Form Annexure – 1)

**8.2** Records shall be maintained by the School

**8.3** Academic mobility appeals to be submitted to PVC/Vice Provost by the student.

## 9. EVIDENCE REQUIREMENTS

**9.1** Appeals must be supported by relevant, verifiable documentary evidence.

**9.2** Unverifiable, altered, misleading, or fabricated evidence shall result in summary rejection.

**9.3** Submission of false evidence may attract action under the Student Disciplinary Code.

## 10. CONFIDENTIALITY & NON-RETALIATION

**10.1** All academic appeal and re-evaluation proceedings shall be handled confidentially.

**10.2** Access to records shall be restricted to authorised personnel only.

**10.3** UPES strictly prohibits retaliation against students who raise academic appeals or re-evaluation requests in good faith.

## 11. FINALITY & CLOSURE

Once the prescribed appeal or re-evaluation pathway under this Policy has been exhausted:

**11.1 No further appeal, representation, or correspondence shall be entertained on the same matter.**

**11.2** This includes representations addressed to the Vice Chancellor outside the scope permitted under this Policy.

## 12. EXCLUSION OF ACADEMIC MISCONDUCT

Academic misconduct, unfair means, plagiarism, or integrity violations shall be governed exclusively by the UPES Academic Integrity & Student Academic Misconduct Policy and shall not be routed through this Policy.

## 13. POLICY REVIEW

This Policy shall be reviewed every three (3) years or earlier if required by regulatory changes or institutional requirements.

# ACADEMIC INTEGRITY & STUDENT ACADEMIC MISCONDUCT POLICY

## *(Including Unfair Means during Examinations)*

**(Policy Code – AG 17)**

*This Policy shall come into force* ***with immediate effect.***

## 1. Purpose

**1.1** The Academic Integrity & Student Academic Misconduct Policy establishes a comprehensive, transparent, and institutionally consistent framework to:

**1.1.1** Define Academic Integrity and Academic Misconduct, including Unfair Means (UFM) during examinations

**1.1.2** Prevent, detect, investigate, and adjudicate academic misconduct

**1.1.3** Ensure due process, proportionality, and adherence to principles of natural justice

**1.1.4** Protect the credibility and integrity of UPES academic qualifications

**1.1.5** Safeguard student rights while maintaining rigorous academic standards

**1.2** This Policy is corrective and educative in intent, while remaining firm against conduct that compromises academic integrity.

**1.3** This Policy shall operate in alignment with:

**1.3.1** The Academic Recovery Pathways (ARP)
**1.3.2** The Academic Grievance & Appeals Policy
**1.3.3** The Student Disciplinary Policy
**1.3.4** Examination and Allied Provisions (as notified by the Controller of Examinations)

## 2. Scope

**2.1** This Policy applies to:

**2.1.1** All Undergraduate (UG), Postgraduate (PG), Doctoral, and Certificate students of UPES

**2.1.2** All Schools and academic units

**2.1.3** All academic assessments and submissions, including:

- Continuous Assessment (CA)
- Mid-Course Evaluation (MCE)
- End-Term Examinations
- Practical, laboratory, studio, viva assessments
- Projects, dissertations, theses
- Online, hybrid, remote-proctored, or take-home examinations

**2.2** This Policy applies irrespective of the mode of delivery or assessment.

## 3. What This Policy Governs

**3.1** This Policy governs Academic Misconduct, defined as acts that compromise the integrity, fairness, or credibility of academic assessment, evaluation, or research.

### 3.2 What This Policy Does NOT Govern

This Policy does not govern:

- Academic performance disputes without misconduct
- Dissatisfaction with marks based solely on academic judgment
- Attendance condonation decisions
- Academic progression, probation, recovery, or entitlement decisions

Such matters shall be governed by the relevant UPES Academic Policies.

## 4. Definitions

| Term | Definition |
|---|---|
| **Academic Integrity** | Adherence to ethical principles of honesty, trust, fairness, respect, and responsibility in learning, teaching, assessment, and research. |
| **Academic Misconduct** | Any act or attempted act by a student that provides an unfair academic advantage or compromises the integrity of the academic process. |
| **Unfair Means (UFM)** | Any act, attempt, or assistance during an examination that violates examination rules or compromises fairness or security. |
| **Fit-to-Sit Principle** | A student appearing for an assessment is deemed fit to sit, unless exceptional circumstances prevented prior disclosure. |
| **Academic Judgment** | Professional evaluation of academic work by faculty based on approved rubrics and learning outcomes. Academic judgment is not appealable. |

## 5. Categories of Academic Misconduct

| Category | Nature & Description | Illustrative Examples |
|---|---|---|
| **Examination-Related Misconduct** | Dishonest conduct connected to assessments compromising fairness | Copying, answer sharing, unauthorized materials |
| **Plagiarism** | Presenting another's intellectual work as one's own | Copy-paste without citation, self-plagiarism |
| **AI-Related Misconduct** | Misuse of AI tools that misrepresents authorship | Submitting AI-generated work without disclosure |
| **Fabrication & Falsification** | Manipulation or creation of false academic data | Invented data, altered records |
| **Misrepresentation** | Providing false information for academic benefit | Forged medical certificates |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Research Misconduct** | Ethical violations in research | Data suppression, unethical experimentation |

## 6. Unfair Means (UFM) During Examinations

### 6.1 Definition

Unfair Means (UFM) refers to any act, attempt, or assistance during examinations that compromises integrity.

Attempted UFM shall be treated at par with committed UFM.

### 6.2 Detection & Reporting

UFM may be detected and reported by:

- Invigilators / Proctors
- Examination Supervisors
- Controller of Examinations (CoE)
- Online Proctoring Systems
- Faculty (based on post-examination evidence)

All cases shall be:

- Documented using prescribed format
- Supported by material evidence
- Forwarded to the CoE

### 6.3 Classification of UFM

| UFM Level | Nature | Illustrative Examples | Indicative Penalty | Governance Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Level U1 – Minor** | Procedural / inadvertent | Possession without use | Cancellation of component + warning | Repetition escalates |
| **Level U2 – Major** | Clear intent or usage | Copying, device use | F grade in course; no supplementary | Overrides recovery entitlements |
| **Level U3 – Severe** | Organized or egregious | Impersonation, tampering | Semester cancellation / suspension | May trigger disciplinary proceedings |

### 6.4 Adjudication Mechanism

**6.4.1** All UFM cases shall be adjudicated by the **University Academic Integrity Committee (UAIC)**

**6.4.2** School-level committees shall not adjudicate examination UFM

**6.4.3** Penalties shall be implemented by the CoE after approval

### 6.5 Interface with Recovery Policies

**6.5.1** UFM penalties determine the academic outcome for the course

**6.5.2** Where UFM penalty specifies ineligibility for Supplementary / Summer / DR, such restriction shall prevail

**6.5.3** Recovery pathways cannot override confirmed UFM penalties

### 6.6 Appeals in UFM Cases

Appeals may be filed only on procedural grounds:

- Violation of due process
- Incorrect identification
- Evidence handling errors

Appeals shall be governed by the Academic Grievance & Appeals Policy.

Academic judgment regarding evidence shall not be re-examined.

## 7. Levels of Non-Examination Academic Misconduct

### 7.1 Level A – Minor Academic Misconduct

| Aspect | Provision |
|---|---|
| **Nature** | Inadvertent, low-impact violation |
| **Examples** | Improper citation, low similarity plagiarism |
| **Penalties** | Warning, deduction of marks, workshop, resubmission |
| **Record Status** | Internal record only |

### 7.2 Level B – Moderate Academic Misconduct

| Aspect | Provision |
|---|---|
| **Nature** | Clear violation with inferred intent |
| **Examples** | Substantial plagiarism, undeclared AI use |
| **Penalties** | F grade in component/course |
| **Recovery** | Governed by ARP subject to penalty |
| **Escalation** | Repeat offence → Level C |

### 7.3 Level C – Severe Academic Misconduct

| Aspect | Provision |
|---|---|
| **Nature** | Serious, deliberate misconduct |
| **Examples** | Fabrication of research data |
| **Penalties** | F grade + suspension |
| **Record Status** | Formal academic record |

### 7.4 Level D – Gross / Egregious Misconduct

| Aspect | Provision |
|---|---|
| **Nature** | Fraudulent or malicious conduct |
| **Examples** | Credential fabrication, organized cheating |
| **Penalties** | Termination / Degree revocation (where permissible) |
| **Record Status** | Permanent institutional record |

### Governance Notes

- Academic judgment is not appealable
- Penalties are proportionate and progressive
- Repeat offences escalate automatically
- Recovery pathways cannot override confirmed penalties

**8. Reporting & Preliminary Review (Non-UFM)**

**8.1** Misconduct may be reported by faculty or academic offices

**8.2** Prima facie review shall be conducted

**8.3** Level A cases may be resolved at School level unless contested

**9. Investigation & Hearing**

| Level | Adjudicating Authority |
|---|---|
| **Level A** | Faculty Member |
| **Level B** | School Academic Integrity Committee (SAIC) |
| **Level C & D** | University Academic Integrity Committee (UAIC) |

Principles:

- Right to be informed
- Right to be heard
- Conflict-of-interest disclosure
- Documented proceedings

**10. Decision & Communication**

**10.1** Decisions shall be reasoned and documented

**10.2** Communicated via ERP

**10.3** Reflected in academic records where applicable

**11. Appeals**

**11.1** Appeals permitted only on:

- Procedural irregularity
- Bias
- Disproportionate penalty

**11.2** Appeals shall not re-assess academic judgment

**11.3** Governed by Academic Grievance & Appeals Policy

**12. Interface with Student Disciplinary Policy**

**12.1** Academic and disciplinary proceedings may run in parallel

**12.2** Sanctions shall be coordinated to avoid duplication

## 13. Record Keeping & Confidentiality

**13.1** Records retained for minimum 5 years

**13.2** Access restricted to authorized personnel

**13.3** Confidentiality strictly maintained

## 14. Non-Retaliation

UPES strictly prohibits retaliation against any student reporting or contesting misconduct in good faith.

## 15. Policy Review

This Policy shall be reviewed every three (3) years or earlier if required by regulatory changes or institutional requirements.

# Student Discipline Policy/Code of Conduct/ Proctorial Board (Disciplinary Committee Constitution/Functions/Process of Handling Complaint

**(Policy Code: DS-01)**

*This Policy shall come into force* ***with immediate effect.***

## 1. Purpose

**1.1** UPES is committed to maintaining a safe, inclusive, disciplined, and academically enriching environment for all members of the University community. Discipline is integral to character building, academic excellence, mutual respect, and responsible citizenship.

**1.2** This **Student Discipline Policy and Code of Conduct** is framed in consonance with the **UPES Regulations Governing Maintenance of Discipline among Students, 2009 (as amended from time to time)** and applicable statutory provisions.

## 2. Applicability

This Policy shall apply to:

**2.1** All students of UPES, irrespective of Programme, school, year of study, or mode of enrolment.

**2.2** All activities conducted **within or outside the campus**, including hostels, internships, industrial visits, fieldwork, online platforms, and off-campus events.

**2.3** All students admitted **before or after** the notification of this Policy.

## 3. Objectives of the Policy

The objectives of this Policy are to:

**3.1** Promote discipline, integrity, and ethical conduct among students

**3.2** Ensure a safe, respectful, and inclusive academic environment

**3.3** Prevent acts of indiscipline, misconduct, harassment, ragging, and violence

**3.4** Define expected standards of student behaviour and accountability

**3.5** Provide a transparent framework for handling disciplinary violations

## 4. Code of Conduct for Students

All students of UPES shall:

**4.1** Maintain **good conduct, orderly behaviour, and discipline** within and outside the campus

**4.2** Uphold the **values, traditions, and reputation** of the University

**4.3** Devote themselves sincerely to academic pursuits and maintain a **conducive learning environment**

**4.4** Treat faculty, staff, fellow students, and visitors with **respect, dignity, and courtesy**

**4.5** Comply with all **University rules, regulations, policies, and lawful instructions** issued from time to time

**4.6** Refrain from any act that may bring **disrepute to the University**

## 5. Types of Misconduct

Any act of misconduct committed inside or outside the campus and formally reported shall be construed as a violation of discipline. Acts of indiscipline can be categorized into following categories:

**5.1** Classroom Misconduct

**5.2** Minor Act of Indiscipline/ General Misconduct

**5.3** Major Act of Indiscipline

**5.4** Zero Tolerance offences

**5.5** Off Campus Misconduct

| **Category** | **Nature of Misconduct** | **Illustrative Acts *(Indicative, not exhaustive; refer Annexure for detailed list)*** | **Disciplinary Severity / Applicability** | **Competent Authority** |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Classroom Misconduct** | Misconduct during teaching–learning activities | • Disruption of classroom decorum • Disobedience of faculty instructions • Rude, disrespectful, or discourteous behaviour towards faculty or classmates • Inattentiveness or deliberate non-participation during lectures • Unauthorized use of mobile phones or electronic devices • Proxy attendance • Damage to classroom furniture, ICT tools, or academic infrastructure | •Verbal warning/ verbal admonishment• Written warning/written admonishment •Assignment of additional academic tasks •Change of seating arrangement • Removal from the classroom for the session. • Confiscation of mobile phone up to **three (03) days** (in case of unauthorized use) • Debarment from attending the concerned class(es) for up to **five (05) working days** | Concerned Faculty Member teaching the course |
| **Minor Acts of Indiscipline / General Misconduct** | Acts affecting campus discipline but not amounting to grave misconduct | • Violation of prescribed dress code • Non-carrying or refusal to produce University Identity Card • Smoking within campus or within 100 meters outside campus • Noise disturbance affecting academic activities • Violation of traffic, vehicle usage, or transport rules • Public indecent or obscene | • Verbal or written admonishment • Written warning • Assignment of additional academic or corrective tasks • Debarment from attending all classes up to **three (03) working days** • Extension up to | Proctorial Board / Chief Proctor |

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | behaviour • Negligence towards assigned academic/administrative work • Disobedience of lawful instructions of University authorities. • Quarrel, argument, conflict with abusive words with other students, faculty/staff. • Consumption/Possession of vape, cigarette, breezer inside campus/campus hostel | **five (05) working days** in exceptional cases (with approval of Chief Proctor / Dean – School) • Written warning with intimation to parents/guardians • Notarized affidavit signed by student & parents* • Mandatory counselling (up to **six months**) • Debarment from academic or co-curricular activities • Disqualification from holding student representative positions • Suspension from academic activities up to **seven (07) working days** • Debarring University assistance for summer internships / campus placements (with approval of Director/Dean – AD&I) • Assignment of social service tasks up to **fifteen (15) days** | |
| **Major Acts of Indiscipline** | Serious misconduct affecting safety, order, or institutional integrity | • Damage, defacement, or destruction of University, staff, or student property • Non-compliance with hostel, library, laboratory, or safety rules • Disruption of academic, examination, administrative, or residential activities • Forgery, tampering, or misuse of University documents or records • Unauthorized entry or involvement of outside elements • Gambling within campus or student residences • Cyber misconduct, hacking, or misuse of IT infrastructure • Defamation of the University or | • Recovery of pecuniary loss (including library resources) • Debarment from library services up to **three (03) months** • Debarring from appearing in examinations • Withholding of scholarships (if applicable) • Non-issuance of Migration Certificate • Disqualification from further studies or re-admission • Rustication from the University • | Proctorial Board / Chief Proctor |

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | its authorities • Mass bunks or boycott of examinations/classes • Violation of safety norms or tampering with safety devices • Physical assault -Hard push, slapping, punching. • Harassment -Bullying, humiliation, mental harassment (campus/outside/social media). • Possession, consumption, or small-scale supply of banned substances | Expulsion from the University • Imposition or extension of disciplinary probation • Mandatory counselling exceeding **six months** • Suspension from academic activities exceeding fifteen **(15) working days.** Notarized affidavit signed by student & parents*<br><br>Expulsion from campus hostel | |
| **Zero-Tolerance Offences** | Acts attracting immediate and stringent disciplinary action | • **Ragging** in any form inside or outside campus, including hostels and private accommodations (cognizable offence) • **Sexual harassment,** including creation, possession, or circulation of MMS/digital content • **Discrimination or harassment based on gender, caste, religion, race,** region, disability, or physical appearance • **Misconduct with University employees** (faculty, staff, or support staff) • **Fights, brawls, violence,** or physical altercations among students or with University employees • **Possession, consumption,** or supply of banned substances (alcohol, drugs, intoxicants, prohibited chemicals, etc.) in large quantity | Immediate inquiry and imposition of stringent penalties, Suspension for 1 Semester or Rustication for 1 year from University.<br><br>**Expulsion from the University**, in accordance with applicable University policy | Proctorial Board / Chief Proctor |
| **Off-Campus Conduct *(Applicable across all categories)*** | Misconduct occurring outside campus but linked to | • Misconduct during internships, industrial visits, fieldwork, or excursions • Indiscipline during seminars, conferences, competitions, or public events • Misuse of online platforms, social media, or | Treated at par with on-campus misconduct; penalties applicable as per relevant category | Proctorial Board / Chief Proctor |

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | University affiliation | digital forums • Any behavior outside campus that harms the reputation, dignity, or interests of the University | | |

**Failure to Appear Before Authorities**

If a student fails to appear before authorities when required for any of the above categories of indiscipline , Chief proctor/Proctorial Board can take following action:

- Suspension from attending classes until compliance
- Blocking of attendance portal
- Intimation to parents/guardians
- Suspension revoked only after reporting to the concerned authority

## 6. Disciplinary Probation

The **Chief Proctor** may place a student on disciplinary probation:

**6.1** Up to **six (06) months** on recommendation of the Proctorial Board Disciplinary Committee, or

**6.2** For a period **exceeding six (06) months**, with **approval of the Vice Chancellor**

Disciplinary probation is a **severe formal reprimand** imposed after the establishment of misconduct.

## 7. Implications of Disciplinary Probation

**7.1** Disciplinary probation signifies that the student's conduct is under **strict institutional observation**.

**7.2** It covers misconduct occurring **both within and outside the campus**, including socially unacceptable behaviour that adversely affects the University's image.

**7.3** Illustrative (not exhaustive) examples include:

**7.3.1** Consumption of alcohol in public places

**7.3.2** Public display of affection on campus or public spaces

**7.3.3** Creating noise or disturbance in classrooms or corridors

**7.3.4** Use of abusive or derogatory language

**7.3.5** Derogatory remarks against UPES or its authorities on social media

**7.3.6** Carrying food or beverages into classrooms or corridors

**7.3.7** Unauthorized use of restricted washrooms

**7.3.8** Misconduct during Industrial visits/ Educational tours/ Internships/Sports, cultural, co-curricular or extracurricular activities

## 8. Conditions During Probation Period

During the probation period:

**8.1** The student's conduct shall be **closely monitored** by the Proctor and Course Coordinator
**8.2** Parents/guardians shall be informed and may be required to visit the University
**8.3** The student shall be allowed to attend classes and marked "Present"
**8.4** The student **shall not participate in any co-curricular, extra-curricular, cultural event, or industrial visit** without **prior written permission** of the School Discipline Controller

## 9. Appeal & Review

Students have the right to submit a written appeal for review of the decision to the Final Appellate Committee (FAC) within 10 days of the punishment order issued by the Chief Proctor Office, via email at **fac@ddn.upes.ac.in**.

# A Culture of Clarity, Accountability & Excellence

At UPES, policies are not rules to restrict; they are frameworks to empower.

They ensure fairness.
They protect integrity.
They build trust.

We encourage every student and member of the University community to engage with this Manual, understand their rights and responsibilities, and contribute to a culture of transparency and academic excellence.

UPES remains committed to continuous improvement, regulatory alignment, and student-centric governance.

*We welcome your feedback and suggestions. Please write to us at* ***upespolicies@upes.ac.in***